Communication Techniques

Practice file

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What to practice for the final exam?

- **Theory- all topics**
- **Memo, email, business letters (positive, negative, persuasive)**
- **Proposal**
- **Reports**
- **Genre analysis**
- **Document analysis**
- **Presentation/ technical talk**
- **Document design (flyer, advertisement)**
- **Instructions**
- **Questionnaire/ survey form design**
- **Refining a document**
- **Language: subject-verb agreement, parallel writing, plain writing**

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4. Contents in Detail

The course is divided into eight units of two weeks each.

Specific Objectives	Course Contents
Introducing the basic concepts of audience, purpose, and genre; Introducing ethical issues and conducting research	**Unit I: (2 hrs)** Thinking about audience, purpose, and genre; Leading and misleading the reader: - ethics at work - ethics for students - how is ethics related to technical communication? - researching technical subjects
Writing for the workplace; Style in technical prose	**Unit II: (6 hrs)** Writing email and letters for the workplace; - writing messages: email, memos, letters - writing messages: informative, positive, negative, persuasive - how is ethics related to technical communication Writing technical prose: - clarity, cohesion, conciseness, parallelism
Designing technical documents; Incorporating visuals into technical	**Unit III: (2 hrs)** Designing documents and page layout; Communicating through visuals

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Writing effective proposals; Writing instructional documents	**Unit IV: (3 hrs)** Writing winning proposals: Writing how-to documents: - instructions, procedures, and manuals
Testing instructional documents; Reporting technical information, part 1	**Unit V: (2 hrs)** Testing and reporting document usability; Reporting technical information: - recommendation reports
Reporting technical information, part 2; reporting technical information, part 3 and accessing technical documents online	**Unit VI: (3 hrs)** Reporting technical information: - white papers or information reports; Taking technical communication online: - sharing documents electronically
Writing documents to be used online; Status or progress reports	**UnitVII: (3 hrs)** Taking technical communication online: - writing online documents; Reporting technical information: - status or progress reports
Presenting technical information orally; Students present some aspect of their major projects	**Unit VIII: (9 hrs)** Oral presentation of technical reports; Student presentations of major project

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Memo Format

MEMO

TO:
FROM:
DATE:
SUBJECT:

Head

……
……

……
……

Name in short

Body

CC:
Attachment:

Tail

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Parts of Memo

- **Head**
  - -To (Name and designation of the recipient)
  - - From (Name and designation of the sender)
  - - Date (Complete and Current)
  - - Subject (Topic of the memo)
- **Body**
  - - Introduction
  - - Main points
  - - Close
  - - Signature
- **Tail**
  - - CC (persons who might be receiving copies of memo)
  - - Attachments (lists, diagrams, pictures, tables and other information)

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MEMO

TO: All Staff

FROM: Ravi Chitrakar, General Manager

Date: May 10, 2018

Subject: Participating in upcoming book fair

Our company will be participating in the Nepal Education and Book Fair 2018, from May 15 to 22 at Bhrikuti Mandap, Exhibition Hall, Kathmandu. We will set up our stall in the early morning of May 10 and we will be involved in this big event in a big way this year.

Except for some staff in the sales department, everyone has been assigned specific tasks at the fair. They should report directly to our stall at Bhrikuti Mandap during the period of the fair.

Please review the attachment for your role in the fair.

rc

CC: Staff members

Attachment: Book fair task for individual staff

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Memo

To: all staff

From: The Manager

Date: may 27, 2010

Subject: Suggestions to Economize the Operating Cost

It has come to my attention that there has been unwise use of paper, electricity and other office materials in our company resulting the high operating cost. In order to bring about a balance between market price and the operating cost of the company, We have to minimize in using paper and electricity. Unless we bring a perfect balance, we have to decrease the number of staff in the office.

Saving electricity can also help us manage the office to a larger extent. Similarly, we should be more economical in using printing papers. While printing the documents we can use both side and with small fonts as well.

By the same token, we can also be economical in using stationary items. When the office is off, it is imperative to switch off the mains. Instead of dispatching letters and memo, it is better to send messages through email and other electronic mediums. It will also help us to save paper and ink to some extent.

My point is that we should use the materials and electricity wisely to bring about positive outputs. I thank conscious use of resource may help to minimize the operating cost.

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Regards,

S.K.Adhikari

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To: All Staff

From: The Manager

Date: September 17, 2017

Subject: Tobacco Use Policy

From December 25, 2017, a company wide ban on the use of tobacco products will go into effect. The purpose of this policy is to promote a healthy workforce and work environment.

Employees and visitors will not be allowed to use cigarettes, cigars, pipes, or smokeless tobacco anywhere on the company ground, including the parking lot and parking garage. In addition, tobacco use will not be allowed in company vehicles or in personal vehicles parked on the company ground.

The detailed tobacco use policy can be found in the policies folder at the company website. Please contact Ms. Bimala in Human Resources if you have questions regarding this policy. Her telephone extension is 234. You can also contact her at ghartibimala@yahoo.com

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Regards,

……

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From : All Staff

To: Supervisor

Date: September 17, 2017

Subject : Poor Working Environment

We wish to express our concern regarding the bathroom facilities in the office. There is only one rest room in our department, so we have to face problems being in queue in the rushing business hour. Similarly, due to the congested room we have found it difficult to manage things. The computer table too is short to work on it effective and comfortably.

As our department is no basement, it is rather cold and gloomy in the absence of sunlight. We therefore, expect the proper management of central heating system and electricity so that we will be motivated to perform our duties and responsibilities effectively.

We, the undersigned hope that you will take swift action and help us work smoothly and effectively. We will be happy to cooperate in any way we can.

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Best Regards,

Sony Gautam, Employee Representative

(On behalf of all staff, Goods Delivery Department)

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Question

You are the CEO of a tech company and have noticed that employees are not adhering to company policies. Write a memo to your staff outlining your expectations and emphasizing the importance of following company procedures.

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Job application Format

Sender’s address
Date

Receiver
Organization
Address

Subject :
Dear sir/ madam,

.....

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…

I am writing to express my interest in…/ With reference to/ In response to the advertisement../ I wish to apply……. .Since I meet all required qualification and experience condition, I have preferred this post. I am a young, energetic, dynamic and dedicated candidate having sound academic background and work experience in this field. I have passed…… I have been working in …….as ……for….. My work experience includes…… I possess sound command in both spoken and written English. I have attached my resume and other testimonials along with this letter.

If I am given an opportunity to work in your company, I will discharge my duties and responsibilities most sincerely.

Looking forward to hearing from you soon.

Yours sincerely

…….

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A sample

Mahendranagar, Kanchanpur
May 20 , 20….

The Human Resource Manager
The Food and Agriculture Organization (UNO)
Kathmandu, Nepal

Subject : A job application

Dear Sir/ Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in acquiring a position of Senior National Administrative Officer in your organization. I am very familiar with your organization's excellent reputation in the field of agriculture and food supply in Nepal and abroad. Since I meet all required qualification and experience conditions, I have preferred this job.

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My experience encompasses 5 years in the field of supply and marketing in UNDP. I possess excellent persuasive communication skills and I am able to communicate with people at all job levels. I am experienced in administrative and logistic skills at both national and international level. I hold M. Phil. degree in business management from TU, Nepal. I am extremely detail oriented, highly motivated and my work ethic is second to none.I possess sound command in both spoken and written English. I have attached my resume and other testimonials along with this letter.

If I am given an opportunity to work in your company, I will discharge my duties and responsibilities most sincerely.

Looking forward to hearing from you soon.

Yours sincerely

…….

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Resume/CV

- Heading
- Career objective
- Summary of qualification
- Education
- Work experience
- Trainings
- Capabilities and skills
- Awards, honours and activities
- Hobbies and interests
- References

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Min Prasad Dawadi
Dudhpokhari 2, Lamjung
Phone- 9848727039, office- 099418131
Email- dawadiminprasad@gmail.com

Objective: To gain excellence in the field of teaching language and literature

Academic Qualification:

- M.Phil.in English (Running)
- M. Ed., in English from TU, 2011
- M. A., in English from TU, 2003
- B. Ed. in English, from TU, 2003
- B.A. in English from TU, 2001
- Intermediate in Mgmt. from TU, 1998
- SLC, from HMG Board Nepal, 1996

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Contd…

Work Experience:

- Working as PGT English at SAMV Chitwan since 2076, Bhadra
- Working as a lecturer at Bhuwanishankar Multiple college, Chitwan since 2076 Mansir
- Worked as an Assistant Professor at Janajyoti Multiple Campus, Kanchanpur since 2063 B.S.
- Worked as an Assistant Professor at Amity College, Kanchanpur since 2066 B. S.
- Worked as an English language instructor of Hospitality English at Far-western Educational Foundation, Kanchanpur since 2072 B.S.
- Worked as the campus Chief of Janajyoti Multiple Campus from 2071 to 2073 B.S.
- Worked as Higher Secondary English Teacher at Jaycees Higher Secondary School, Kanchanpur from 2068 to 2070 B.S.
- Worked as secondary level English Instructor at Newton High School Kathmandu from 2060 to 2063 B.S.

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TRAINING AND PARTICIPATION

- Advanced English language course from Instituto d' Alberta, Kathmandu
- English Conversation and Proficiency Course from American Language Centre , Kathmandu
- Paper presentation on 4th NELTA Coference, Kanchanpur
- Participation in two day training on Research and Report Writing conducted by FoM, TU
- Participation in dissemination program on semester system of MBS and M.Ed. Conducted by TU
- Participation in an orientation program on Evaluation system conducted by PU

HONOR:

Received letters of appreciation for 100% result in 2067 B.S., 2070 B.S., 2071 B.S. and 2073 B.S. from Janajyoti Multiple College, Kanchanpur

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Affiliation:

Life member of NELTA

Life member of Scholars' Association of Nepal

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Contd…

TEACHING SPECIALIZATIONS:

- General English
- ELT and Linguistics
- Sociolinguistics, SLA and Applied Linguistics
- Literature and Critical Thinking
- Business and Managerial Communication
- Hospitality English

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RERERENCES:

Mr. Bholanath Sharma, Campus Chief, Janajyoti Multiple Campus, Kanchanpur
Mr.Rabindra Awasti, Principal, Amity College, Kanchanpur

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Mani Ram Pandey
Mahendranagar, Kanchanpur – 18
Phone- 9848730071, office- 099520270
Email- mnrmaniram12@gmail.com

Objective: To gain excellence in the field of teaching English language

Academic Qualification:

- M.Phil.in English Education (Running)
- M. Ed., in English from Central University, 2068 B.S.
- B. Ed. in English from Janajyoti Campus, 2065 B.S.
- Intermediate in English from Janajyoti Higher Secondary School, 2061
- SLC, from International Public Secondary School, 2059

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Cont..

Work Experience:

- Working as an Assistant Professor at Janajyoti Multiple Campus, Kanchanpur since 2068 B.S.
- Working as a Higher Secondary Level English teacher at Shree Jaycees Secondary School, Kanchanpur from 2072 B.S.
- Working as an Assistant Professor at Amity College, Kanchanpur since 2076 B. S.
- Working as an IELTS instructor at Mirai Consultancy, Kanchanpur since 2076 B.S.
- Worked as an IELTS instructor at Mero Consultancy, Kanchanpur from 2068 to 2070 B.S.
- Worked as Higher Secondary English Teacher at Sunrise Public School, Kanchanpur from 2068 to 2072 B.S.
- Worked as an English teacher at Sunrise Public Secondary School, Kanchanpur from 2062 to 2066 B.S.

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TRAINING AND PARTICIPATION

- Advanced English language course from RTC, Kathmandu
- Participation in one day training on Research and Report Writing conducted by TU
- Participation in dissemination program on semester system of M.Ed. conducted by TU

HONOR:

Received letters of appreciation for 100% result in 2073 B.S. from Janajyoti Multiple College, Kanchanpur

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Affiliation:

Life member of NELTA

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TEACHING SPECIALIZATIONS:

- General English
- Phonetics & Phonology and Linguistics
- Sociolinguistics
- Research Methodology
- ELT
- Academic Writing
- LanguageTesting
- Business and Managerial Communication

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RERERENCES:

……, Department Head, English Education, TU, Kritipur

Mr. Rabindra Awasthi, Principal, Amity College, Kanchanpur

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Business Letter Format

- **Head**
  - Logo/Contact
  - Your address
  - Ref (Reference)
  - Date
  - “Confidential” heading (if applicable)
  - Receiver’s name and address
  - Subject Line (optional)
  - Salutation
- **Body**
  - Opening paragraph
  - Main body of the letter
  - Closing paragraph
- **Tail**
  - Complimentary close (valediction)
  - Signature
  - Printed name
  - Enclosures/attachments
  - Copies

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Elements of a letter

[Organization logo]

[Your name]

[Address]

[City, POBox]

[Today's date]

[Name of recipient]

[Title]

[Company]

[Address]

[City, POBox]

[Subject]

Dear[Name of recipient]: (If unknown, use "To Whom It May Concern")

[Short introduction paragraph, stating purpose]

[Additional information]

[Closing information, summary or thank you as appropriate]

Sincerely,

Sign for the letters sent by mail or fax)

[Your name]

[Title – if applicable]

Enclosures:

CC:

Head

Body

Tail

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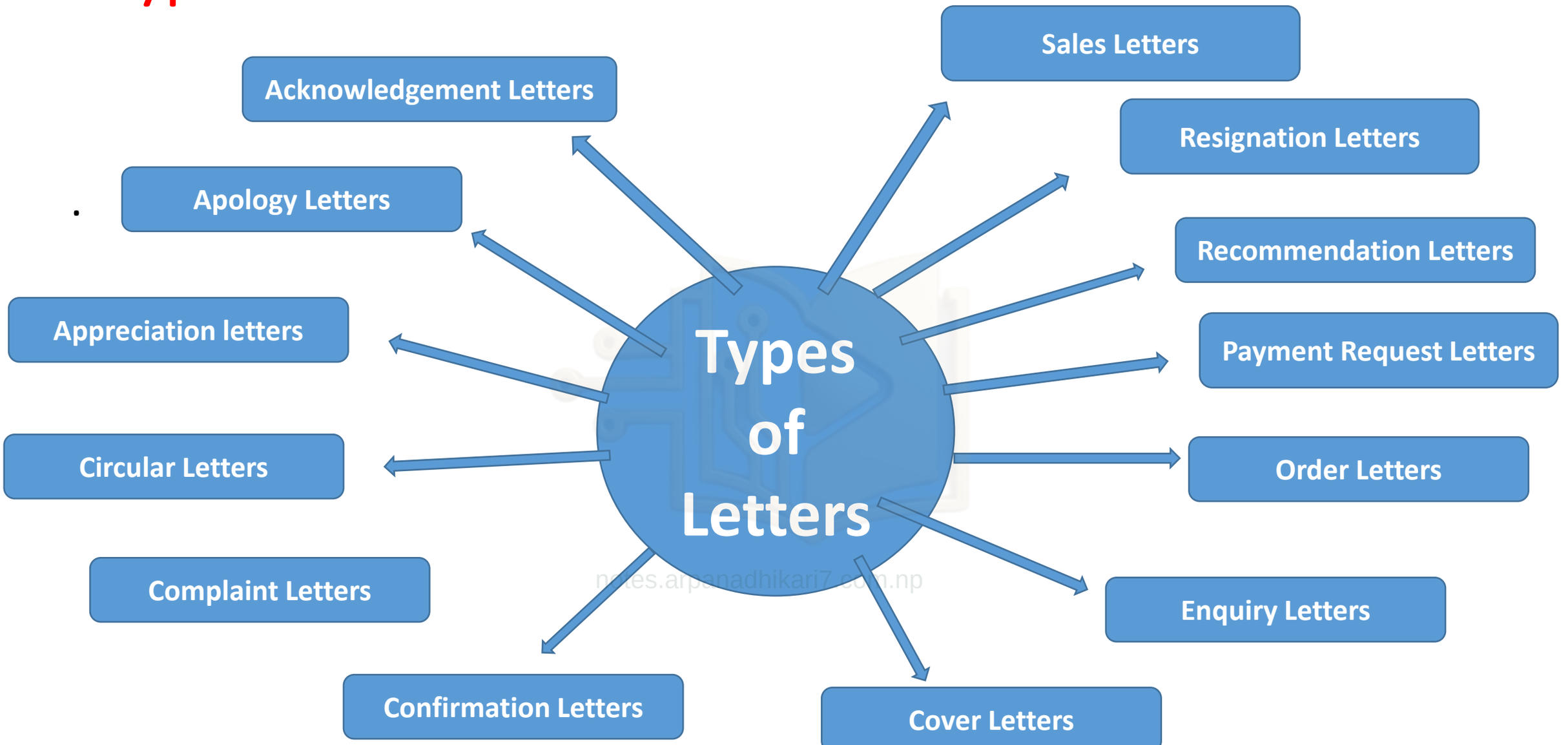
2.2.2 Types of Letters



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Writing messages

The messages that you write in the workplace will fall into four general categories:

- **Informative**
- **Positive**
- **Negative**
- **Persuasive**

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Informative messages

Informative messages usually present readers with information they need (or you need them to have); encourage recipients to read, understand, and respond, either neutrally or positively, to this information; and downplay any negative elements.

Additional goals for informative messages include ensuring readers think well of the writer and his or her organization and providing complete information to forestall any additional communication.

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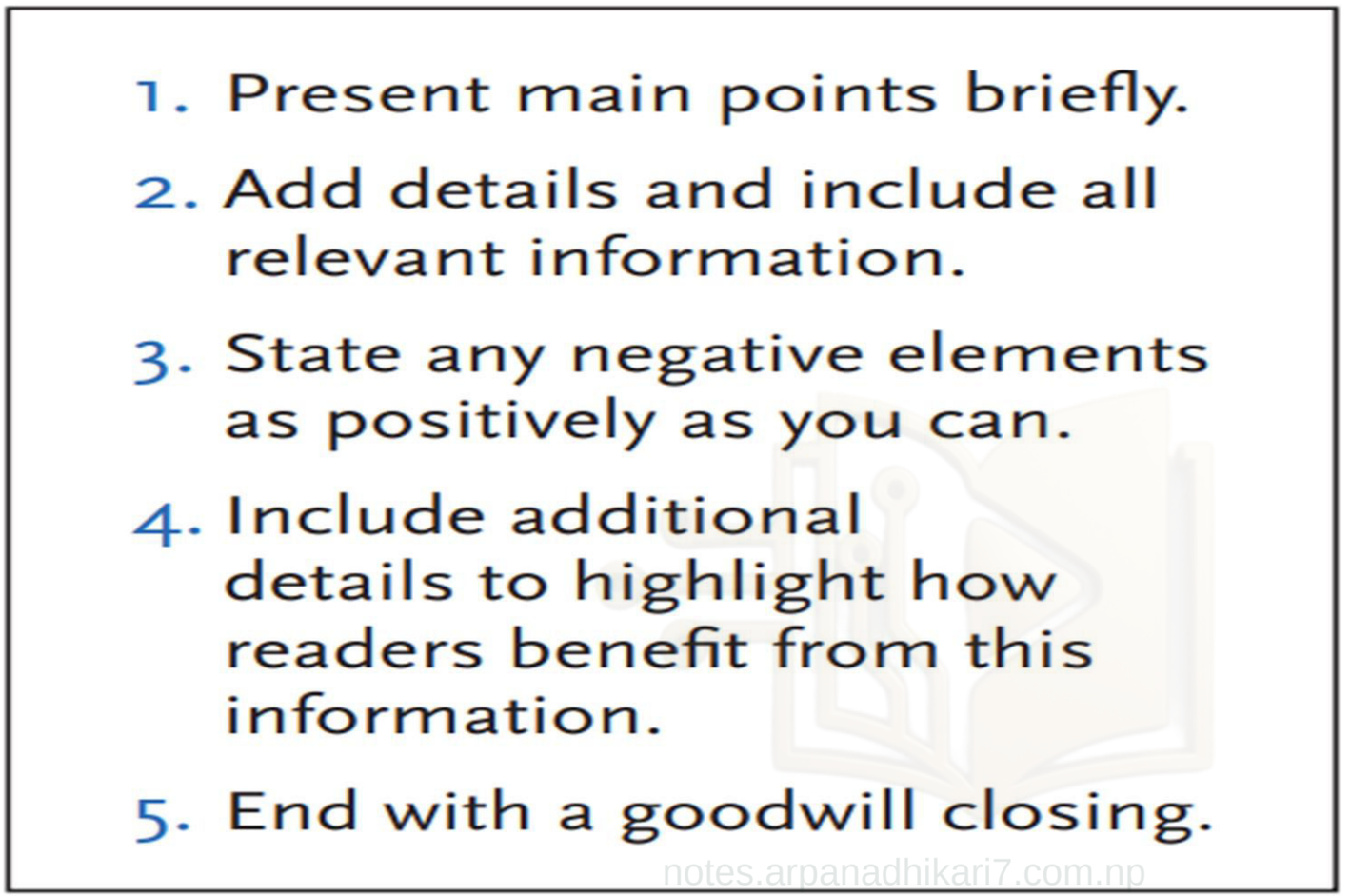

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FIGURE 7.6
A basic organizational pattern for an informative message.

Activate Windows

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Positive messages

Positive messages have several goals including sharing good news; downplaying any negative elements; and ensuring that readers read, understand, and respond positively.

In addition, these messages also include the secondary goals of ensuring that readers think well of the writer (you and your organization) and that no further communication is needed on this topic.

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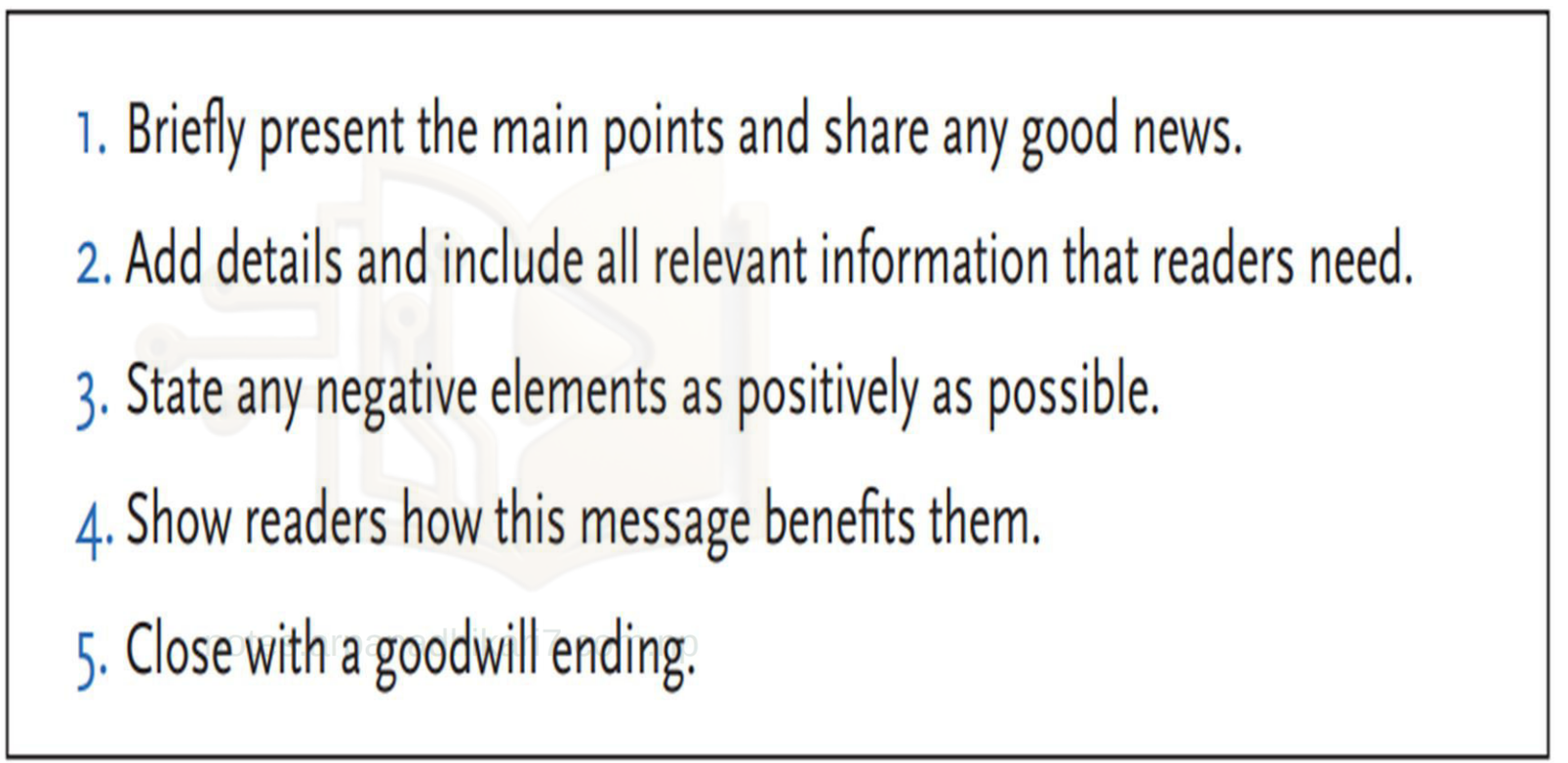

FIGURE 7.7
A basic organizational pattern for positive messages.

Activate Win

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To: hgraves@home.telus.ca
From: jesmith@elitewashingmachines.com
Subject: Washing Machine User Manual
Date: January 7, 20XX

Dear Ms. Graves,
Thank you for your recent message inquiring about how to obtain a user manual for your new front-loading washing machine. Here at Elite Washing Machines, we stopped shipping user manuals with our new appliances in 2007 as part of a company-wide policy to adopt greener business practices. Instead, we now post PDF copies of our appliance user manuals online on the customer service page of the company website, thus eliminating the significant demand for paper products caused by print copies. This policy allows us to revise our user manuals regularly to ensure customers have access to the most up-to-date information whenever they need it. It also allows customers to access the correct manual whenever convenient for them.

Here is the webpage where you can find a copy of the manual for your model:
www.elitewashingmachines/customerservice/appliances/wash.html

Please note that the PDF manual has a hyperlink table of contents on page 3 that allows you to locate and jump to the particular section of the manual that you wish to use. You may then use the information online or print off the section relevant to your needs. You are also welcome to print off the entire PDF document if you desire; however, I would remind you that accessing the file online will also ensure that you access the most current version of the manual when you need it.

If you have difficulty locating the manual that you need or finding the relevant information once you locate the manual, please note that Elite Washing Machines has an online help chat service (www.elitewashingmachines/customerservice/help.html) where you can ask questions about any of our products and receive a timely response from one of our online help staff any time of the day or night.

Again, thank you for purchasing an Elite machine for your washing needs.

Sincerely,
Jenna E. Smith
Customer Service Representative
Elite Washing Machines, Inc.
www.elitewashingmachines.com

FIGURE 7.8 A positive and informative message that uses a traditional pattern of organization.

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Sample letters

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Request massage for information about banquets facilities in Himalayan Hotel,Lalitpur.

Serving Mindas Consultancy.
KMC-12 ,Thapathali ,Kathmandu
Estd. 2004
www.servingminds.com
00977-1265347
Fax:4-5-653-2
August 11, 2017

Himalayan Hotel Pvt. Ltd.
LMC-17, Kupandole, Lalitpur, Nepal
www.hotelhimalayan.com

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Subject: Request for information about Banquet facilities

Dear Mr. Shrestha,

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Would you please provide information regarding your banquet facilities?

We are considering holding our Annual business party for 265 of our personnel at your hotel on August 25, 2017.Our decision will be based on the answers to the following questions:

1. Is your facility available from 9 am. Until 3 pm on that date. We will need the additional time for setup and takedown.

2. Do you offer free use of audiovisual equipment? We will need a color projector and screen. We should supply the portable computer.

3. Do you have a variety of hot lunches that can be served table side for between Rs 200 and Rs 250?

We expect your timely information for us to make our site selection by August 15.

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Yours sincerely,

Ramesh Bhandari

Director,SMC

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A *letter to the owner of a hotel requesting a family reservation for your holiday*.

Bhakatpur Municipality-18

Suryabinayak, Nepal

April 10, 2018

The Manager

The Crown Hotel

KMC-20,Darbarmarg

Kathmandu,Nepal

Dear sir,

We would like to stay a week at your hotel from 12-22 April, and would appreciate information about your prices for one double room for my husband and myself, and rooms for our three children,(two boys aged 8 and 10 and girl aged 15,).

Could you please also send us detail of what you provide; for example do you have a car park, are three facilities for children, and what will be the approximate price of accommodation for one week?

With many thanks, I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Yours faithfully,

Sanaya Gurung

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REPLY

The Crown Hotel KMC-20, Darbarmarg

Kathmandu, Nepal

Ph.: 00977-4657459

Fax.:4-567-435

www.thcrownhotel.com

April 12, 2018

Subject: Reservation

Dear Madam,

We would enjoy making a reservation of rooms in our hotel for your holiday. From 15 to 22 April, we can comfortably provide you rooms of your choice.

Regarding the facilities which you have mentioned in your letter, we have got a spacious parking area and a beautiful playground for the children under tight security.

They can enjoy different games, swings etc.

As you are going to use double room and other rooms for the children for a week, the cost will be approximately Rs. 12000 including lunch and dinner.

Please call me at 555-3288 to let me know how we might serve you for your holiday refreshment.

Yours faithfully,

Sanjay Singh

Manager, TCH

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Negative messages

Negative messages are those that you expect readers to receive with anger or disappointment.

The goal of a negative message is to communicate the information in a way that readers can accept, to diffuse any negative emotions as far as possible, to forestall any additional communication on this topic, and to maintain the reader's good will towards the writer (you and your organization).

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How to write negative message?

Option 1: Use a Buffer First

1. Open with a buffer (a neutral or positive statement to delay the negative).
2. State the negative information once clearly.
3. Present any possible alternatives or compromises.
4. Close with a positive, goodwill ending.

Option 2: State the Reason First

1. State the reason for the negative information or refusal first.
2. State the negative information once clearly.
3. Present any possible alternatives or compromises.
4. Close with a positive, goodwill ending.

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Activate Wind
Go to Settings to a

To: jon.black@blackhome.shaw.ca
From: jschwartz@blencairngaming&technicalsupport.com
Date: April 17, 20XX
Subject: DigiPro 20XX Expansion Pack Availability

Because we no longer stock AllPro Game Engine software, we are unable to make the new DigiPro 20XX expansion pack available to you. However, there are several online gaming sites that continue to handle AllPro Game Engine software where you should be able to obtain a copy of the expansion pack. These sites include Calling All Gamers, Megamode Download, and Fear the Reaper. The URLs for these websites are easily obtained through an online search engine such as yahoo! or google.com. We apologize for any inconvenience, and we hope that you enjoy your expansion pack once you are able to find a copy.

Jason S.

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SAMPLE

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Samjhana Publication Pvt. Ltd.

New Baneswor, Kathmandu, Nepal

Phone: 00977-45362723

Website: www.samjhanapublication.com

Septembe,23, 2017

Subject: Regarding Dashain Bonus

Dear All,

We regret to inform to you that due to the current economic crisis, the management has decided that we will not be giving Dashain bonus to our employees this year. We find this action necessary in order for us to cut costs due the recent market scenario. We understand that this will create some difficulties for you during festive period but we believe that taking this step is far better than laying off several employees or cutting down salary or benefits. With your help this will be only a temporary setback. Should any other changes arise, we will inform you.

We have experienced downturns before and rebounded perfectly well. We are confident this slump will be improved in the next fiscal year. Your continued excellent work shall surely allow our company to recover from our current situation very soon.

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With best regards,

Deepak Bdr. Malla

(Chief Accountant)

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Indirect Approach: Rejecting Application Letter

Mega Bank Nepal Pvt. Ltd.

Darbarmarg, Kathmandu

Phone: 00977-23415675

www.megabanknepal.com

September 11, 2017

Dear Mr. Gupta,

Thank you for your interest in applying in Mega Bank Nepal. Our evaluation team was quite interested with your academic excellence along with your resume and cover letter.

Despite the fact that your resume and cover letter were very impressive, our evaluation team did not select it for further consideration as it found another candidate's application and resume more relevant at this point of time.

We will, however, keep your resume on record and get in touch with you about future opportunities that may be a better fit for your skills and experiences.

We wish you all the best in your job search and hope we will have the chance to consider you for another role in the future.

Regards,

Ramesh Chaudhary

(Assistant HR Manager)

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Persuasive messages

- Persuasive messages are those that you expect readers to resist.
- For example, the increase in airline prices due to rising fuel costs might lead your organization to change reimbursement procedures for employee travel. Whereas the company may have purchased the airline ticket for you in advance or even refunded the cost immediately after you bought it, it now requires you to submit boarding passes along with your ticket receipt so that your refund comes several weeks following your return.
- **Persuasive messages fall into two categories:**

a. Direct requests

b. Solution-finding messages.

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a. Direct request messages

- **When you ask readers to do something for you, you are asking them to act. People act when they are motivated to do so. Motivating readers requires that you know how or what they think, for example, anticipating resistance they might have to your request.**
- **To figure out possible sources of resistance or objections, ask readers (if they are available) or analyze them and the situation to identify potential obstacles.**
- **Obstacles or objections often arise from three areas:**

- **emotional reasons,**
- **practical reasons, or**
- **misapprehension.**

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How to organize a direct request

1. Introduce the subject.
2. Summarize the background to the subject (postpones request to avoid being rude or too direct).
3. Request action.
4. Include all details so the reader can act.
5. Motivate the reader to act on the request.
6. Remove obstacles to reader action and acceptance.

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b. Solution-finding messages

A solution-finding message generally identifies a problem (shared by you and readers) and proposes a solution.

This type of message becomes persuasive when you induce readers to accept (and act on) the solution that you propose.

As in direct request messages, consider whether readers might object to your solution so that you can anticipate and overcome any potential obstacles.

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How to organize a solution-finding message?

1. Establish common ground with your readers.
2. Describe the shared problem.
3. Explain the proposed solution.
4. Explain why the action requested is necessary.
5. Show how readers benefit from this solution.

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SOME SAMPLES OF PERSUASIVE MESSAGES

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SAMPLE

Sample Sales Letter to Customers

GreenClean Gets Your House Sparkling Clean and Helps the Environment

****Your Business Logo Here****

Sandra Smith
555 Weston Way
Vacaville
FLA, 33505

Dear Ms. Smith,

For as little as $150 you can have your entire home clean and sparkling, without enduring the nasty odor of chemical cleaners. We care about the environment and use only state-of-the-art green cleaning methods to ensure that you and your family are not exposed to any harmful or allergy-causing cleaning products. You'll love what we do because:

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Contd.

- All our cleaning products are completely non-toxic—safe for children and pets!
- We leave surfaces clean, sparkling, and hygienic.
- Our staff are bonded and fully insured.
- We offer senior discounts to those aged 65 and over.

Satisfaction is guaranteed. If you are not happy with the service, we promise to make it right. As one of our customers says, "GreenClean does a top-notch cleaning job for a reasonable price."

Another of our customers says, "I can't believe they get things so clean and sparkling without the use of toxic chemical cleaners!"

Call us at **250-342-8923** or email us at **info@greenclean.com** for a free estimate. Get your house cleaned and do your part to help the environment!

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Sincerely,

James Hallom
GreenClean Inc.

P.S. We are offering a 10% discount for first-time users of our service until the end of the year.

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SAMPLE LETTER

[Senders Name]
[Address line]
[State, ZIP Code]

[Letter Date]

[Recipients Name]
[Address line]
[State, ZIP Code]

[Subject: Normally bold, summarizes the intention of the letter]
-Optional-

Dear [Recipients Name],

We know that you've been looking for that perfect cake to have at your child's birthday party. The one that will make his or her eyes glow with wonderment and appreciation. The Good Baker has finally completed and is ready to show off our new line of birthday cakes for this year! We have added many more themes and flavors from which you may choose! We're sure to have just what you need.

So for that particular occasion, there is no place better to get your cakes from than The Good Baker, especially now that we've revamped our product line. Place an order now!

Sincerely,

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[Senders Name]
[Senders Title] -Optional-

[Enclosures: number] - Optional -
cc: [Name of copy recipient] - Optional -

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Tips for writing effective email messages

- **Keep business and personal email separate.**
- **Think twice before you hit “send.**
- **Proofread before you send.**
- **Keep private information confidential.**
- **Write informative subject lines.**

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Tips for writing email

1. Use a short and accurate subject header

Use a short and accurate subject in your email. Include a keyword that will make the Email content easier to remember. For example,

- Meeting regarding school parents day (formal)
- Coming to Pokhara (informal)

2. Begin with a proper salutation/greeting

Begin your email with a greeting, such as **"Dear Ramesh"**. If your relationship with the reader is formal, use the person's title (Mr. Mrs. Ms. or Dr.) with their family name (e.g. **"Dear Mr. Koirala"**). If the relationship is more casual, you can simply say, **"Hi Ramesh"**. If you don't know the name of the person you are writing to, use: **"Dear Sir/Madam"**.

3. Thank the recipient

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If you are replying to someone's inquiry, you should begin with a line of thanks. For example, if someone has a question about your company, you can say, **"Thank you for contacting ABC Company".** If someone has replied to one of your emails, be sure to say, **"Thank you for your prompt reply"** or **"Thanks for getting back to me".**

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4. State your purpose

If you are starting the email communication, it may be impossible to include a line of thanks. Instead, begin by stating your purpose. For example, **"I am writing to enquire about …"** or **"I am writing in reference to …"**.

Make your purpose clear in the email, and then move into the main text of your email. Keep your sentences short and clear. Also pay careful attention to grammar, spelling and punctuation.

5. Add your closing remarks

Before you end your email, thank your reader and add some polite closing remarks. You might start with **"Thank you for your cooperation"** or **"Thank you for your**

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consideration" and then follow up with, **"If you have any questions or concerns, don't hesitate to let me know"** and **"I look forward to hearing from you"**.

6. Use the correct form of leave-taking.

The last step is to include an appropriate closing with your name. This will depend on your level of intimacy with the recipient. In a formal email you can use any one of the following:

- Yours sincerely,
- ***Sincerely,***
- Yours faithfully,
- Yours cordially,
- Respectfully,
- Best,
- Your student,
- ***Best regards,***

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In an informal email you can use any one of the following:

- ***Best wishes,***
- ***Cheers,***

Finally, before you hit the send button, review and spell check your email one more time to make sure it's truly perfect!

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Samples

3 Key e-mail addresses accurately

The time is inserted automatically by your computer

Use an appropriate subject heading

Keep your salutation informal and friendly

E-mail messages are much less formal than other business documents, sometimes more chatty

Finish off informally too

To Thomas.Sigel@pearson.com
From Shirley.Taylor@cfb.co.uk
Date Mon 21 September 200–
Time 12:23:45 +0000
Subject Communication for Business 4th edition

Hi Thomas

Thanks for your email today. I'm glad you enjoyed your holiday in Canada.

I'm happy to report that I've been able to progress very well with the new edition of Communication for Business. I've received help from some friends and colleagues which has been very valuable. I've also been in touch with lots of big companies who have very kindly given permission for me to use some of their documents in my book.

I should be able to wrap everything up by the end of this month. Would you like to come up and collect the work next week? Shall we say Wednesday 30 September at our usu table in the Red Lion Hotel in Todwick?

Please let me know if this is OK with you.

See you soon.

Shirley

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To: luckybikram@gmail.com
Subject: English courses

Dear Mr Thapa,
I am writing in response to the advertisement I saw for your English school in "The Kathmandu Post" magazine. I am interested in doing one of your courses and I would be grateful if you could provide some further information.

Firstly it says in the advertisement that the courses are two weeks long. Would it be possible to do a three-week course? I would also like to know how much your courses cost exactly.

Secondly, your advertisement mentions accommodation with host families. Could you tell me if I would be staying on my own with the host family or if there would be other students staying there as well?

Finally, I have a question about the social programme. Would you mind sending me more details about this? I am very keen on sport and I would like to know if there are any sports activities included in the social programme.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,
Milan Ghale

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Professional Email Example

To: Michaeljordana@HavardUniversity.com

Cc:

Bcc:

Subject: Information of the master's degree program in environmental of education

Dear Mr Jordan.

I am Gareth Bale and I called you two days ago regarding the details of the master's degree in environmental education that is offered in your university. You wanted to me to send an email with the questions regarding the course.

I want to know when the course is opened and also about the job training that is offered by your university. Can a student choose an desired internship? Are there any placements special offered to meritorious students and whether there is a provision forgiving a scholarships to low income students. It would be nice if a brochure could be delivered with all these details.

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Kindly send me the details at the earliest as I am planning to get started on the course that beginning as soon as possible.

Thanks and regards,

Gareth Bale

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Four Point Plan For Structuring Messages

1. **INTRODUCTION (Background and Basics)**
   Why are you writing?
   Set the scene.
   Maybe refer to a previous letter, contact or document.

2. **DETAILS (Facts and Figures)**
   Give information/instructions.
   Ask for information.
   Provide all relevant details.
   Separate into paragraphs.
   Ensure logical flow.

3. **RESPONSE or ACTION (Conclusion)**
   Action the reader should take.
   Action you will take.
   Give a deadline if necessary.

4. **CLOSE (A simple one-liner)**
   Sometimes all that is needed is a simple one-line closing sentence.

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From	johnwang@stelectronics.co.sg
Date	14:10:03 12:30:45
To	suzieliu@videoworks.com
CC	
Subject	25th anniversary video

Dear Suzie

Thank you for inviting me to visit your studios last week. I was most impressed by your new facilities.

« Intro

I am delighted that you can accept our invitation to produce a video to celebrate the company's 25th anniversary. This is a very special landmark in our history, and it is important that this video portrays both past, present and future.

« Details

I look forward to receiving a draft outlining your thoughts for this special video. Please send this to me by 30 October together with your approximate costings.

« Action

If you need any further information please give me a call on 62757272.

« Close

Best wishes

John Wang
Marketing Manager
ST Electronics
www.stelectronics.com

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PROPOSAL

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What is the standard generic format for a proposal?

- **Problem Statement / Background**
- **Purpose**
- **Topics to Investigate**
- **Audience**
- **Methods and Procedure**
- **Qualifications and Resources**
- **Work Schedule**
- **Budget (if appropriate)**
- **Call to Action**

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Brief structure for exam

- **Cover page**
- **Introduction**
- **Problems**
- **Objectives**
- **Solution strategies/ methodologies**
- **Management and budgeting**
- **Output/ expected outcome**
- **Conclusion**

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A QUICK START GUIDE TO POWERPOINT® FOR COLLEGE AND UNIVERSITY STUDENTS

Problem Statement

An important part of an engineer's education is the public presentation of various class projects. While a few students were fortunate enough to learn the basics of presentation programs such as PowerPoint® in high school, many were not. Professors expect them to be familiar with such a program because they assign numerous public presentations on student class projects. These assignments mean that students who are not familiar with PowerPoint® must quickly learn it, on top of getting used to their new lives at the university, the challenging subject matter in their classes, and the homework load. Most students want to be able to generate a creative and professional presentation because it will boost their GPA. However, most first-term engineers don't have spare time during which they can struggle with the basics of the program. Existing manuals, such as Finkelstein's *How to do Everything with PowerPoint®*, (400+ pages, 1.6 lbs., lists at $25.00 USD), Lowe's *PowerPoint® 2012 for Dummies* (300+ pages, 1.2 lbs., lists at $20.00 USD), or Wempen's *PowerPoint® 2012 Bible* (800+ pages, 2.9 lbs., lists at $40.00 USD), are too large, too heavy, and too expensive for the average college student. Imagine the panic that most students must feel upon opening Wempen's 800+ page tome at 2 a.m. to figure out how to insert a data chart for their presentation scheduled for 8:30 later that morning! What these students need is a short (20 pages max.) guide that lists only the functions they need for their presentations in class.

I propose to create this quick-start guide especially tailored to first-year undergraduates in engineering, as well as other majors who have little time to learn new computer programs. It will briefly cover the basics (assuming most students know how to open and save files, etc.) and focus mainly on the flashy elements that make a student presentation memorable.

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Purpose

The main purpose of the Quick Start Guide is to provide a fast entry for busy college and university students into some of the more complex functions of PowerPoint®. They need and want to be able to add the more impressive features of the program (such as dissolving text, custom animations, and so on) to their class presentations to ensure that they are memorable as well as informative. A secondary purpose is to introduce the basics quickly and briefly, with the main focus of the manual being on the more sophisticated functions.

Topics to Investigate

While already expert at using PowerPoint®, I want to build my knowledge further to be sure my instructions are as complete and up to date as possible. So I plan to study existing PowerPoint® manuals for useful tips and tricks that I can include in my student-targeted version. I also plan to interview three or four of my classmates in my general engineering class to get feedback on their perspectives concerning which aspects of PowerPoint® are most useful to know. I will also talk to three or four students in other majors to gather broader feedback about the needs of students other than engineers as well.

Audience

My primary audience for this manual is comprised of first-year engineering students with a basic knowledge of the program (e.g., how to add points to a slide) but who want to learn the more advanced capabilities quickly. My secondary audience will be students in programs outside of engineering who also want to know more about PowerPoint® to improve the quality of their class presentations. I expect that communications and journalism majors will be especially interested in this manual because they have to do a lot of oral presentations as part of their coursework too. The initial audience will, of course, be Professor Patel, the instructor for this course.

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METHODS AND PROCEDURES

The first stage of this project will be to interview the students, as mentioned earlier, to get feedback about what the target audience sees as its primary needs in such a manual. Since I will have to fit these in around my full schedule of classes, I expect it will take about a week to complete these. An additional step will be to examine the existing published manuals for PowerPoint® to get some insight into their specific shortcomings that my manual will address, as well as tips and tricks that might be new to me but useful to include in my manual.

When I feel that my research has given me enough supplementary information, I will decide which functions will be most useful to my users. Then, I will draft an outline of the functions, with estimations of the approximate length of each section. These functions I will order from most to least importance to my audience, so I can omit the less important ones if the manual seems that it might become too long. This stage should take only a day or two because it is mainly organizational.

The third step will be to begin drafting the manual. I plan to use screen shots to illustrate the steps. After I complete the first function, I will have several of my classmates look over the instructions to see if they are clear, complete, and easy to follow. Using their feedback, I will continue to develop the rest of the functions according to my priorities established in stage two. This will be the most time-consuming stage of the process, probably taking two to three weeks.

The fourth stage will be to user test the draft manual with two or three first-year students who fit the user profile described above. I will try to get at least one student outside of engineering, but, since my primary audience is first-year engineers, I will definitely have at least two of my test users from this group. This stage will take about one and one-half to two weeks.

Following the user tests, I will revise my draft instructions, making whatever changes are necessary to be sure I have created the best possible set of instructions for my target user group. These final revisions will likely take two or three days.

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QUALIFICATIONS AND RESOURCES

As a five-year user of PowerPoint® not only in school settings but also at an organization where it was the primary word-processing program available (no kidding!), I am uniquely qualified to create this manual. Given the constraints of my employment situation from 2009–2011, I figured out how to do things with PowerPoint® that no one else can do (e.g., create an animation starting with a basic clip art drawing). I am also a second-year engineering student who has helped countless classmates learn the secrets of the program so that they can improve the quality of their presentations, so I have a good idea of the needs and background of this group of students. My expertise is legendary; people seek me out to help them who aren't even engineers because friends give them my name. Third, I have several friends who are journalism and communications majors that I can interview for additional perspectives on the needs of my target users.

Work Schedule

Task	Estimated Time	Completion Date
Interview students	One week	September 22
Examine existing manuals	One week	September 29
Establish content priorities	Three days	October 3
Draft one function and receive classmate feedback	One week	October 10
Complete draft	Three weeks	November 1
Usability testing	Two weeks	November 15
Revisions based on testing	One week	November 22
Submit completed manual	Up to two hours travel time to campus	November 23

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Budget

There are no significant costs associated with this project. I plan to go to the local bookstore and examine existing manuals from the shelves. Since I buy my textbooks there, the managers should have no problem with me using their facilities to study the books for an hour or two. Of course, there will be some printing costs associated with this project, but only slightly more than the average costs for a class. There are also binding costs for the draft and final copy of the manual, but those will be between $10 and $15 dollars. If I decide to print the illustrations in color, I may need to purchase a new ink cartridge for my printer, and that will cost about $100.00. But I will need to replace the ink cartridge at some point anyway, whether I create this manual or not. The total possible cost for creating this manual will be between $15 and $115.00 (worst case scenario).

Call to Action

With nearly 1500 new first-year students on campus this term, there is a potentially wide audience for this manual on this campus alone. Once I complete this project, hundreds of first-year students will find their first year of study just that much easier because they will have access to a brief guide tailored specifically to their needs. And several professors will notice the quality of the oral presentations in their classes improve as students are able to present their ideas in exciting and innovative ways. Please approve this project as quickly as you can, so I can begin the first stage of research as soon as possible.

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MAJOR PROJECT 8.1

WRITING A PROPOSAL

Option to Write a Manual (option 1)

Write a proposal to create an instructional manual that *does not currently exist*: that is, you need to identify a process or procedure that has not been documented for a particular audience but that you would be qualified to create.

If there are procedures that could be documented at your place of employment but are not, you may propose to create a manual that could be used at your workplace.

In the proposal, do the following:

- Explain the subject matter for the manual that you propose to create.
- Explain your plan to assemble the reference material you need to write and illustrate the procedures that a particular audience has need of but that are not currently available.
- Include an argument showing that the manual you propose does not currently exist but is needed.

The topic of your proposal is open, which is disconcerting at the start. However, the best work is generally that which genuinely seeks to solve real-life, real-time problems. To help you get started, here is a list of topics that other students have worked on in the past.

- Manual for college students on how to use PowerPoint® to create oral presentations
- Quick reference guide to using the advanced functions of a Nokia flip phone
- Orientation manual for new employees
- Manual for creating a website for a student using HTML
- Reception desk manual
- Guide for college students for converting to vegetarianism
- Guide to using clipart to create original animations in PowerPoint®
- A children's color-based guide to solving the Rubik's cube

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Question

Assume that your organization is planning to introduce a new product or service, and you are tasked with writing a proposal to convince the management to approve the project. Develop a proposal that includes an introduction, problem statement, objectives, methodology, budget, and expected outcomes.

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Reporting technical information

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Types of technical reports

- **The status or progress report**
- **The information report or white paper**
- **The laboratory report**
- **The recommendation report**

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Status report: Format

- **Introduction**
- **Work Completed**
- **Work to Be Completed**
- **Overall Assessment of Progress**

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STRUCTURE OF A STATUS REPORT

Beginning:

INTRODUCTION OR PROJECT DESCRIPTION

This section should refresh your reader's memory on your project and briefly summarize its central points.

Middle:

WORK COMPLETED

- Task 1
- Task 2

This section details the work that you have completed, task by task. If you encountered any problems with these tasks, you also describe the actions that you took to resolve the difficulties.

WORK REMAINING

- Task 3
- Task 4

This section describes the tasks that still remain before you complete the project. It lists the tasks that remain, but with limited elaboration. Any potential obstacles that you anticipate may be mentioned here, as well as solutions that you propose.

COST

Report on how much budget has been used to this point and how much remains. Explain any discrepancies between the plan and reality.

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End:

OVERALL ASSESSMENT OF PROGRESS TO DATE

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Conclude the status report by appraising your progress to this point for your supervisor. Assess whether you believe the project will be completed as anticipated in the proposal. If you have any recommendations about changes to the plan or schedule, include those here.

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MEMO

To: Professor Chang
From: Rebecca McGregor
Subject: Status report on training manual for co-op students at SportSystems Unlimited
Date: October 7, 20XX

Project description

SportSystems Unlimited is a growing manufacturing firm that produces arena boards for in-line skating pads, hockey rinks, and indoor soccer fields. Recently, they have hired several mechatronics engineering co-op students to help write programming code for a robot they have installed that will increase productivity as well as product quality. So far, the company lacks any orientation or training information that would help newly arrived co-op students quickly learn the basics about the business. I am writing a manual that documents the basic information and procedures that new students need to know about SportSystems Unlimited when they arrive. This manual will be a quick reference to answer basic questions that students may have about the products that SportSystems sells and the procedures that they need to know as they get started on their assigned projects. The manual covers the following topics:

- An overview of SportSystems' products and specialties
- A brief description of the key employees and their areas of expertise and responsibility
- Previously undocumented office procedures often assigned to co-op students (e.g., how to answer the phone and direct calls).

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Work completed

Interviews conducted: content selected

This project is progressing well, for the most part. So far I have hit my deadlines to this point, having selected the content for the manual and drafted the first five pages, which give an overview of the company and its products. I had a little bit of trouble scheduling the interviews at first because two of the three people I needed to talk to were out of town during the week that I had scheduled to interview them. However, I was able to meet with them early the following week, and they were very helpful in suggesting what information they wanted new employees to learn. I drafted an outline of the content and had it approved on September 30.

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R. McGregor—2

Work remaining

Since I have decided on the manual content and drafted the first third, covering SportSystems' products and specialties, all that remains is to write the personnel and responsibility descriptions and to document the office procedures that I had to learn during the first few weeks of my work term. To illustrate these procedures, I will use a combination of digital photos and screen shots. The owners have given me permission to visit the company this weekend to create the visuals, and I am hoping that I can complete the draft and the graphics by Oct. 17.

Midterms start on Oct. 18, and that may slow down my progress on the usability testing. However, I have built extra time into my project schedule, so I expect to complete the tests on

FIGURE 9.3
Sample status or progress report (conclusion).

Review Copy

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time, even if studying for midterm exams delays me actually running the tests. Two employees of SportSystems have agreed to help me test the manual, and my roommate is going to serve as the third test user.

Overall progress

There has been no major delay to this project. I still have two-thirds of the work to do to complete the draft, but the original schedule seems reasonable, if I continue to complete the tasks as listed. Since I have already lined up my test users and tentative dates for testing, I expect that this project will be completed, tested, and revised by the deadline for this project, December 3.

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Question

- You have been assigned as a quality control engineer for a new bridge construction/software designing project. Write a progress report detailing the works completed, works in progress, and works to be completed, along with any quality concerns that need to be addresse.

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White papers or information reports

- **White papers (information reports) are reports that provide information about a particular topic.**
- **They are distinguished from other types of reports in that they argue a specific position on the issue or pose a solution to a problem by introducing innovations in technology or new products.**
- **In technical fields, especially in the information technology industry, white papers are both technical documents and marketing documents.**
- **From the company's perspective, their purpose is generally threefold:**

- **to inform readers,**
- **to educate them about the advantages of a new product or service, and**
- **to persuade them that this innovation is the superior solution to a particular problem.**

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OUTLINE FOR A TECHNICAL WHITE PAPER

Total length: 5 to 50 pages (optimum length found to be 15 to 20 pages)

Abstract or Executive Summary

LENGTH: One paragraph

CONTENT:

- Summarize the purpose of the paper
- Summarize your findings
- Some controversy over whether to include conclusions in your abstract:
  - Not including the conclusions entices the reader to look beyond the abstract.
  - Including the conclusions results in busy executives not reading further.

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Problem Statement

LENGTH: Two to three paragraphs

CONTENT:

- Describe the problem
- Give a brief background or context for the problem:

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Description of Solution

LENGTH: As long as needed, as short as possible

- Describe how product or service works in general (informing goal)
- Enumerate the features of the product or service
- Explain how product or service applies to the problem stated above
- Include visuals that illustrate the product or explain the service

How Product/Service Solves the Problem

LENGTH: As long as needed, as short as possible

- Show how the product or service applies to the problem (persuasive goal)
- Include evidence
- Show how features of product/service benefit the reader
- Explain why this product/service is superior to other possible solutions
- Acknowledge one or two limitations to demonstrate an unbiased assessment of the solution

Conclusion

LENGTH: One or two paragraphs

- Summarize why your product or service is the best solution to the problem.

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Example

Executive Summary

This report evaluates the existing methods for employees to submit the hours that they have worked to their respective temp agency. Currently, many temp agencies use a paper-based method that encourages waste, inefficiency, and can reduce company productivity.

A new service called "Web-Time" gives employees a valuable alternative to filling out paper timesheets by submitting them online instead. Throughout this report, the costs and benefits of using Web-Time as opposed to paper timesheets will be compared and contrasted. Web-Time has proven itself to be the most useful and effective method of submitting time cards, and the reasons for its successes will be evaluated and explained in further detail.

Activate Windows

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Problem Statement

Technological advancements have created more efficient ways to cope with situations that we face in our daily life. These new methods of doing things are not only more efficient, but can be environmentally sound and financially profitable. Businesses are embracing these technologies by shifting from paper-based systems to electronic processes. Examples include online banking, online course registration at universities, and email. These systems have proven themselves to be invaluable as they save time, frustration, and (occasionally) money for the people who use them.

In the past, employees used to have to punch time cards to mark the beginnings and endings of their shifts as a means of logging their hours. Punched time cards became outdated, and society advanced to filling in timesheets that could be mailed (or even better, faxed!) to employers. Once again, old methodology has become obsolete and has been replaced by a new process.

At First Data Merchant Services, most of the employees have been contracted by assorted temp agencies; they all have different schedules and work in various departments of the business. In order to keep track of the number of hours worked, each week, employees must fill in timesheets that detail what specific hours they worked between, how long their breaks were, and what days they worked.

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HOW WEB-TIME SOLVES THE AFOREMENTIONED PROBLEM

Web-Time allows employees to log their hours online and then submit the hours to their respective supervisors. Each supervisor is then able to log in at his/her own convenience, verify the hours of the employee, and then submit them directly to the temp agency online. (See Figure 3.) The goal of Web-Time is to reduce the amount of time that is wasted by both employees and supervisors and to make it more convenient to submit/verify hours at one's own leisure.

Figure 3: Completed Timesheet

Web-Time is a cost-effective solution for both the temp agency and the company (in this case, First Data) because it reduces printing costs of timesheets and the individual sheets of paper wasted from the fax machine. This system alleviates the stresses of manually filling in a timesheet, rechecking the hourly figures to ensure accuracy, finding a supervisor for a signature, faxing the timesheet, and then waiting for a confirmation to ensure that it was received by the temp agency. Since employees will be able to complete and submit their hours quickly online, they will be able to concentrate on doing their job efficiently and to the best of their ability, which can lead to increased performance and productivity.

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MAJOR PROJECT 9.2

WRITING A WHITE PAPER

Select a new product or device that you know something about, and write a white paper introducing it to readers who will find this innovation helpful.

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The laboratory notebook

- **Experimental descriptions originate in the laboratory notebook. Laboratory reports rest on a foundation of experimental evidence, first recorded in the notebook, so they are only as good as the records made during the experiment.**
- **While you are conducting the experiment, you should be recording clear and detailed notes about the following:**

- **Your actions**
- **Your observations**
- **Your thoughts**

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Format

- **Title (and author[s])**
- **Introduction**
- **Procedure and materials**
- **Results**
- **Discussion**
- **References**

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Recommendation reports

- **In a recommendation report, the technical communicator (or engineer) describes the problem and then presents several possible solutions that he or she has devised based on extensive research.**
- **If the writer has been asked only to recommend several solutions, the report ends with a neutral description of the possibilities.**
- **If the writer has been asked to solve the problem, then he or she will generally end by recommending one solution over the others, explaining what makes it superior.**
- **A variation on the recommendation report is the feasibility report, which discusses the viability of applying one recommended solution to a problem.**

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Format

- Memo or letter of transmittal
- Title page
- Executive summary or abstract
- Recommendations
- Report body (introduction, scope, methods, results, discussion)
- Conclusions
- Notes, references, appendixes

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Short Report (for Exam)

- **Title**
- **Introduction**
- **Objectives**
- **Methods**
- **Findings**
- **Discussion**
- **Conclusion and recommendation**

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Five strategies for writing readable instructions

1. **If the steps must be done in chronological order, then number them; if the order does not matter, use bullet points.**
2. **Phrase steps in the imperative, i.e., as commands (verb + object).**
3. **Put one action in each step.**
4. **If conditions apply to the action, include them in a phrase or dependent clause before the imperative.**
5. **Format actions differently from explanatory information.**

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The Five Parts of Instructions

1. Introduction. The introduction provides necessary background information.

2. List of equipment and materials. When a list is required, be sure to make it complete and clear.

3. Steps. The heart of your instructions consists of clearly distinguished steps that readers must follow.

4. Warnings, cautions, and notes. Warnings tell readers that one step, if not prepared or performed properly, can endanger their safety. Cautions tell readers how to avoid mistakes or to take certain precautions. Notes provide useful side information.

5. Conclusion. When a conclusion is required, offer a brief wrap-up and congratulate the reader.

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Examples

CHANGING A FLAT TIRE

This set of instructions is intended to help the first-timer change a flat tire easily and safely. Before you begin, review the list of equipment, locate it in your car, and assemble it in a safe location near the flat tire.

Equipment

- Jack
- Lug nut wrench
- Four heavy triangular blocks
- Spare tire
- Car manual, turned to information about changing your car tire

Before you begin

1. Make sure your car is pulled well off the road so that both you and your vehicle will remain safe throughout this procedure.

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2. Choose a flat, level area, if at all possible.
3. Place one heavy, triangular block behind each of your rear wheels and in front of your front wheels.
   These blocks will prevent the car from rolling once you have the flat tire jacked into the air.

Set up the jack and loosen the lug nuts

1. Assemble the jack.
   Usually you need to insert the handle into a slot on the jack.
2. Set the jack under the axle and behind the flat tire.
3. Locate the slot on the axle where the jack will engage to lift the flat tire off the ground.
4. Line up the tabs on the top of the jack with the slots on your axle.
5. Wind the jack up until the tabs engage with the axle.
   At this point, do not lift the car off the ground.
6. Using the lug wrench, loosen the four wheel nuts one turn, working in a crosswise pattern around the tire.

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Jack up car and remove flat tire

1. Continue raising the jack until the car begins to lift up and the flat tire is well clear of the ground (usually about 8 inches).
   You need to have space under the axle to fit the inflated spare between the car and the ground.
2. Loosen the wheel nuts the rest of the way.
3. Remove them from the wheel bolts.
4. Place them together on a sheet of plastic or newspaper so that you can easily find them in a few minutes.
5. Remove the flat tire.

Install spare tire

1. Place the spare tire on the axle, lining up the holes with the wheel bolts.
2. Replace the wheel nuts, tightening them finger tight.
3. In crosswise fashion, tighten wheel nuts using wrench.
4. Lower car using jack.
5. Tighten lug nuts as tight as you can, using wrench.

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Finishing up

1. Remove jack.
2. Replace jack, lug nut wrench, flat tire, etc. into your trunk.
3. Carefully remove triangular blocks and replace in trunk.

YOU DID IT!

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Steps to Install and Set up McAfee Antivirus Software

- You can install and set up McAfee Antivirus in two ways - with CD and Retail Card
- **Set up McAfee Antivirus Software with CD**
- Enter the CD to the computer and wait for a few minutes
- After it, a McAfee Antivirus set up pop-up will appear
- If pop-up does not appear, then navigate to your computer drive
- Go to a folder on CD drive in the removable disc section
- Run the set up of McAfee Antivirus and follow the instructions to set it up
- Select language, country, and the custom settings
- Tick check to agree to the terms and the conditions
- Click on install which will update the antivirus software and it settings from the internet
- Then create McAfee account to manage the billings and services
- Restart your computer

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How to prepare ALU DUM (FRIED POTATO IN GRAVY)?

INGRADIENTS

• 1/2 kg	small potatoes
• 2 cup	onion (chopped)
• 1 teaspoon	garlic paste
• 1 teaspoon	ginger paste
• 1/2 cup	tomato (chopped)
• 1 teaspoon	red chilli powder
• 1 teaspoon	coriander powder
• 1 teaspoon	turmeric powder
• 1 teaspoon	methi (fenugreek)
• 1 teaspoon	garam masala
• 3 teaspoon	cashewnut pieces or paste (optional)
• 1/2 cup	yogurt (curd)
	oil for deep fry
	Salt to taste

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PREPARATION

- 1. Boil potatoes until half cooked. Let it cool
- 2. Peel it. Prick potatoes with a fork. Deep fry until potatoes are golden brown.
- 3. Heat 2 teaspoon oil in separate utensil. Add methi/ fenugreek. Add onion when methi turns dark. Cook onions until light brown.
- 4. Add cashewnut and yogurt. Add ginger paste, garlic paste, red chili powder, garam masala, coriander powder, and turmeric powder. Stir for a few seconds.
- 5. Add tomato and cook on a medium heat for few minutes. Add salt.
- 6. Add 1.5 cups of water. Bring sauce to boil.
- 7. Add fried potatoes. Cook for 8 to 10 minutes on low heat.
- 8. Serve hot.

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Instruction to recharge the mobile phone

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Answer

Recharging NTC SIM using USSD

- You need to dial *412#
- Select any of the Nepal Telecom services there.
- Enter the number that you want to recharge.
- Finally, enter the pin code of the recharge card that you want to use for this payment.
- Confirm the balance or payment for that service.

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Recharging through mobile app

- You can also recharge NTC services either your own or others using the Nepal Telecom mobile app.
- Login to your NTC mobile app.
- Go to Recharge now tab, select Self or others. Self means the number with which you are logged in and others for the number of other people.
- You can also scan the recharge card or Enter the pin. You need to allow the app to take pictures and record videos to make the scanning feature work.
- For others, enter the GSM prepaid/postpaid phone and the Pin number to recharge.

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How to make presentation/ technical talk

1. **Greet the audience and introduce yourself**
2. **Say what your presentation will focus on.**

Example:

In my presentation, I will cover the following points:

……

3. Conclude with impressive notes

- **Be brief**
- **Remind the listeners what you have already presented**
- **Use conclusion markers**
- **Be open for queries**

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Models of communication

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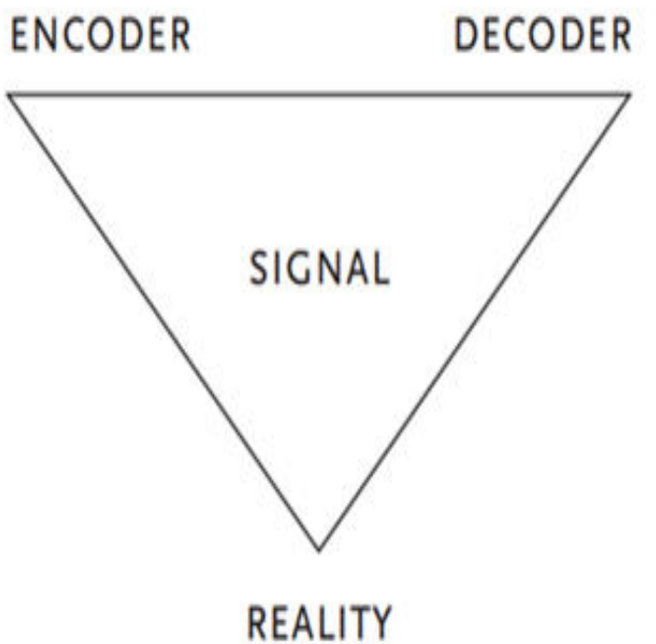
James L. Kinneavy's communication triangle

- **This model shows one way to think about the relationship between writer, reader, and text in any kind of writing.**
- **In this diagram, reality forms a third point on the triangle, which shapes the relationship between the writer (encoder), the reader (decoder), and the text or document (signal).**
- **In technical communication, the text represents a version of reality prepared by the writer for the reader.**
- **Each type of writing focuses on a different aspect of the triangle (expressive, persuasive, literary etc.)**
- **One major flaw in this model is the omission of context.**



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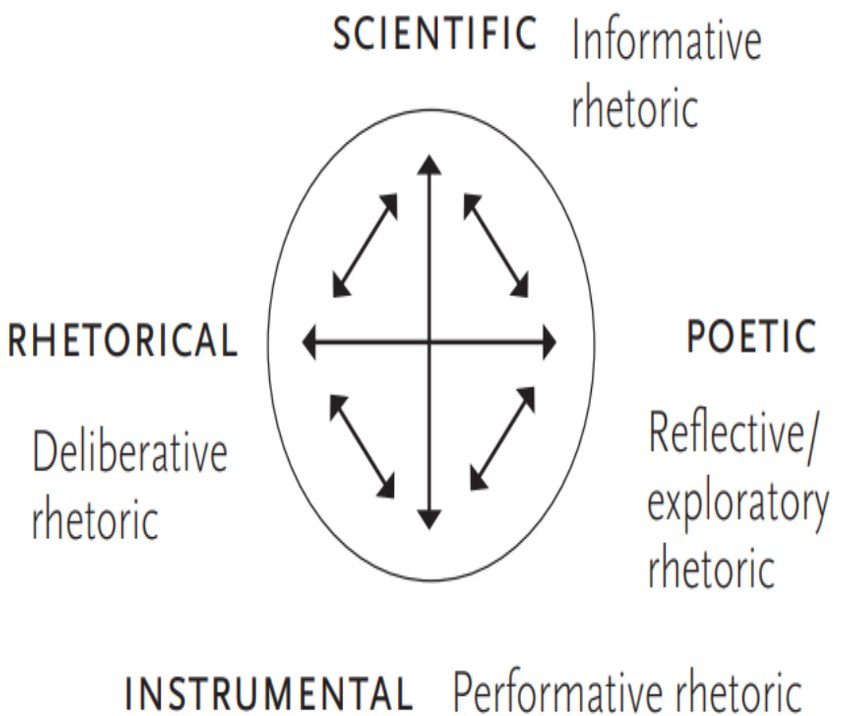
Walter H. Beale's model of communication



- **Beale discusses the purpose or aim of different types of writing.**
- **He focuses on aim to highlight the relationships created between the writer, the reader, reality, and the text in each type of writing. For example, poetic writing (or discourse) relates to the writer and enables the writer's self-expression or self-exploration.**
- **Poetic (or literary) discourse explores writers' personal visions.**
- **Instrumental discourse links readers and reality: they provide information to help readers perform a particular action.**
- **Rhetorical discourse aims to persuade readers—to change their minds about a particular issue or belief (or at least prompt them to consider the writer's viewpoint, even briefly).**
- **Scientific discourse seeks to relate readers to reality differently from writers of instrumental discourse, by informing and educating readers about complex technical ideas.**

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Document analysis

- **Analyze the given document individual from the perspective of the communication triangle:**
- **Who is the writer?**
- **Who is the intended reader?**
- **What are the purposes of the document?**
- **What form does the document take?**
- **In what way does the content of the document represent reality?**
- **What characteristics do these documents share?**
- **What limitations do you see to the communication triangle as you seek to apply it to the selection of documents that you collected?**

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NEW HOT PRODUCT! CHERRY LAPTOP – NEW MODEL!!! [C-312]

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

This new model from CHERRY, C-312, will bring you even more convenience than ever! The following are its better-than-ever features:

-lightweight

-compact

-fast

-long-lasting battery

-equipped with antivirus security

*bonus feature…

-a complete set of microsoft programmes set-up just for you!

SO, HURRY UP AND BRING IT HOME! [available in all electronic retail shops.]

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A Man's Drink
A Woman's Drink
Everybody's Drink

Coca-Cola

Vigorously good---and keenly delicious. Thirst-quenching and refreshing.

The national beverage---and *yours*.

Demand the genuine by full name—
Nicknames encourage substitution.

THE COCA-COLA CO.
ATLANTA, GA.

Trade-Mark Reg. U.S. Pat. Off.

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Parneeta, Fashion Student

NEW

All new Dove, for an all new you.

With unbeatable damage repair*

Sometimes, hair damage can hold you back. New Dove Intense Repair, with ¼ Moisturizing Milk and the power of Keratin Actives, nourishes hair from within and gives unbeatable damage repair. Now carry on being you without the worry of damage.

New refers to new pack and formulation.

O&M 4572

*Damage refers to signs of surface damage. Based on lab test on hair breakage and smoothness evaluation with Dove system vs majority of shampoo and conditioner brands.

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2. Read the following message carefully and analyze the questions based on it. 15

GIFT OF THE MONTH CLUB

March 12, 2023
Dear Valued Customer,
Our records indicate that you have not yet submitted your order for October, and we are wondering what the hold-up is. Everyone is busy these days, but you had better take a few minutes to fill out the enclosed order form as soon as possible. If you don't, we will assume that you are choosing the Halloween Special Selection, "Boo! Who? To You," and we will be shipping it to you if we do not receive an alternate order by November 5.
Your membership here at Gift of the Month Club is valued, but for us to do our part we need you to do your part. So please get your order in to us as quickly as you can.
We look forward to hearing from you in a day or two.
Sincerely,
Lise Gauthier
Sales Associate
Gift of the Month Club
www.giftofthemonthclub.com

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a) Identify the problems with this message from a reader's perspective.
b) Who is the target audience for this message?
c) Identify two or three goals that readers of this message will have.
d) Rewrite this message to address those goals and to show readers how they will benefit from responding to the request.

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RHG Medical Labs

X-RAY SPECIALISTS
BLOOD TECHNICIANS
DIAGNOSTIC & EXPLORATORY
MAMMOGRAPHY
ULTRASOUND ~ MRI ~ CAT SCAN
BLOOD ANALYSIS ~ URINANALYSIS
COLONOSCOPY ~ SIGMOIDOSCOPY
BY APPOINTMENT
DOCTOR'S REFERRAL REQUIRED
BRING REFERRAL TO APPOINTMENT

1257 KING ST. W
LEEDS, AL
~
205-123-4567
SCHEDULING@ RHGLABS.COM

LAB ASSIGNMENT 5.1

CRITIQUING AN EXISTING DESIGN

Examine the advertisement from the perspective of Williams's four design principles.

- Which principles are used effectively?
- Which principles are used ineffectively?
- What changes would you make to improve the overall design?

When you have identified the main aspects that need change, redesign the ad so that it uses all four design principles effectively.

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Users

- **Users are active participants in the performance of the technical communication text.**
- **They are much closer to the actors' role than the audience's role because they make the writer's words live by using them to do something, instead of just passively observing.**
- **Technical communication users are also very different from the types of readers you will address.**
- **The challenge for technical writers becomes how to learn what users already know and what they need to know—and how to provide what they need to know for them where and when they need it.**

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Ways of thinking about users/ types of users

- **Primary audience:** **Your primary audience is the major group of users who will use your instructions.**
- **Secondary audience:** **Rather than following step-by-step through your instructions, he or she may skim/scan the guide, noting forgotten details. He/ she uses it as a reference, not a how-to document. These secondary users have a different level of knowledge than do your primary users, but they may still consult your guide.**

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- **Initial audience:** When you are first assigned the project, your boss (or, in class, your instructor) becomes an initial audience—the individual who will approve your project, affecting whether or not your guide reaches the primary audience.
- **Gatekeeper audience:** This individual is often a supervisor higher up in the organization who will give final approval on your guide, that is, decide whether to publish it. The gatekeeper audience might give feedback about how the guide should contribute to the organization's image, feedback that could result in revisions to its style or arrangement.
- **Watchdog audience:** The watchdog audience might be a government or regulatory organization unconnected with you directly but that reviews the products that your organization creates.

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Question

What do you understand by audience analysis? Analyze the following audiences based on any document (refrigerator) you have designed; primary audience, secondary audience, initial audience, gatekeeper audience, and watchdog audience.

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Brochure designs and advertisements

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BLOOD TECHNICIANS
DIAGNOSTIC & EXPLORATORY
MAMMOGRAPHY
ULTRASOUND ~ MRI ~ CAT SCAN
BLOOD ANALYSIS ~ URINANALYSIS
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Hospitality from the Soul

Welcome to Kabilas Resort & Fun Park

Kabilas Resort & Fun Park welcomes you with the ultimate comfort and luxury, situated in Chitwan, Nepal, Kabilas Resort & Funpark is located at Bharatpur 29, Chitwan 10 KM away from the city center Narayangarh to Muglin-Narayangarh Highway. It is a 3-Star standard resort where you will get to experience supreme services from our professional staffs.

All the rooms are designed to meet the requirements of our guests having all kind of facilities inside them. The rooms are also designed to provide all the amenities and room service.

Kabilas Resort & Fun Park is the most adorable holiday destination in Nepal where you can enjoy having fun in all kinds of water games, dry games, picnic spots, agricultural farms and many more are the center of attraction.

National & International organizations may host their official programmes in the seminar halls available at Kabilas Resort & Funpark.

In the recent years, Kabilas Resort & Fun Park has become the popular destination for picnic & recreation. Siddeshwor Temple, wide range of panoromic views, family villas, open restaurant space, ample space for occassional events etc. are the major facilities of Kabilas Resort & Fun Park.

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WHY KABILAS RESORT & FUN PARK ?

1. Ample Space - 12 Acres Land
2. Adventurous Road
3. Sufficient Parking Space
4. Two Restaurants Dinning Areas and One Bakery Cafe.
5. Two suspension bridges
6. Live music with panoramic view
7. 4 different Seminar Halls of different capacity - 200, 150, 100, 50
8. Luxurious villa including private garden.
9. Adjoining Deluxe Room for family in Resort Area.
10. Indoor games in Rooms Area i.e. Table Tennis, Badminton.
11. Locker facility for Water Park Guest.
12. More than 500 person capacity wave-pool.
13. Multiple choice of Dry games for adults and children.
14. 40 Picnic Spot among 20 Shed and 20 non-shed.
15. Siddheshwor Mahadev Temple on the top of Resort.
16. Backup Power.
17. Any National and International Payment accepted
18. Fire fighting equipment for safety.
19. Free pick-up and drop facility from Dasdhunga Bakery Cafe.
20. Private Booking on Air-Condition vehicles.
21. Organic herbs and vegetation.
22. Organic Animal and Poultry Farm.
23. Moderate Menu Price.

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Fun Park Facilities

We have different packages for visitors (non-residential) guests where room guests are provided ticket with complementary on their stay. We have different ticket & prices - Entry, Dry, Water, Combo for the visitors where they can enjoy on their choice.

The extra privilege can be provided for picnic group according to the size.

Water	Land
Adult:	Adult:
1. Multi Slide	1. Dragon Coaster
2. Body Slide	2. Bumper Car
3. Family Slide	3. Fairish Wheel
4. Wave-pool	4. Frees-bee
5. Rain Dance	5. Break Dance
Child:	Child:
1. Body Slide	1. Bull Ride
2. Family Slide	2. Sun & Moon
	3. Mini Train
	4. Sky Jet

Pre-Reservation Facilities

Kabilas has a different types of reservation procedure - direct phone call on our hotline number, email can be done. There are many kinds of room tariff and packages - European Plan, Bed and Breakfast, Modified American Plan, American Plan. This packages which can be choose by guest as they do prefer. Special rates are given to Corporate clients as per both party MOU. Our sales & marketing team are ever ready to host you.

For rerservation: kabilas@gmail.com, 9855051900.

Dasdhunga Outlet

Kabilas Resort has recently added the facility of the first outlet on the Mugling-Narayangarh Highway at the entry point of Dasdhunga, the visitors may use resort vehicle free of cost and they may park their own personal vehicle at the outlet parking area.

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Restaurant Facilities

We have three restaurants: villa, resort area & das dhunga respectedly. Many national and international guests enjoy in our restaurant having great tastes of multi-cusines food items. Our chef provide a best food and quality in different cuisine (Indian, Continental, Chinese), different ala-chart snacks & thali, bar-b-que. Where camp-fire, live music event, cultural program, DJ night are shown at restaurant premises.

DJ Night on Restaurant

Dining at Resort Restaurant

Hall Facilities

We have four different halls where official programs, seminars, conferences etc. can be held. According to the need we can provide projector, air condition, mic, speaker, intercom.

Koshi Hall

Cultural Dance

Picnic Facilities

The total land of picnic area is 2 hector. For the cleanness and rent it will charge Rs. 2500 per shed including drinking water, electricity, 1 shed (750 sq.ft) & total area of 4000 sq.ft. And the other facility provided are grocery shop, woods, basic utensil.

Organic Farm

In the area of 5 hector, we have managed organic farm, poultry where dragon fruit, rabbit, local chicken, duck, goat, turkey, battai & different kinds of vegetables are available which are the part of menu at restaurants.

Dragon Fruit

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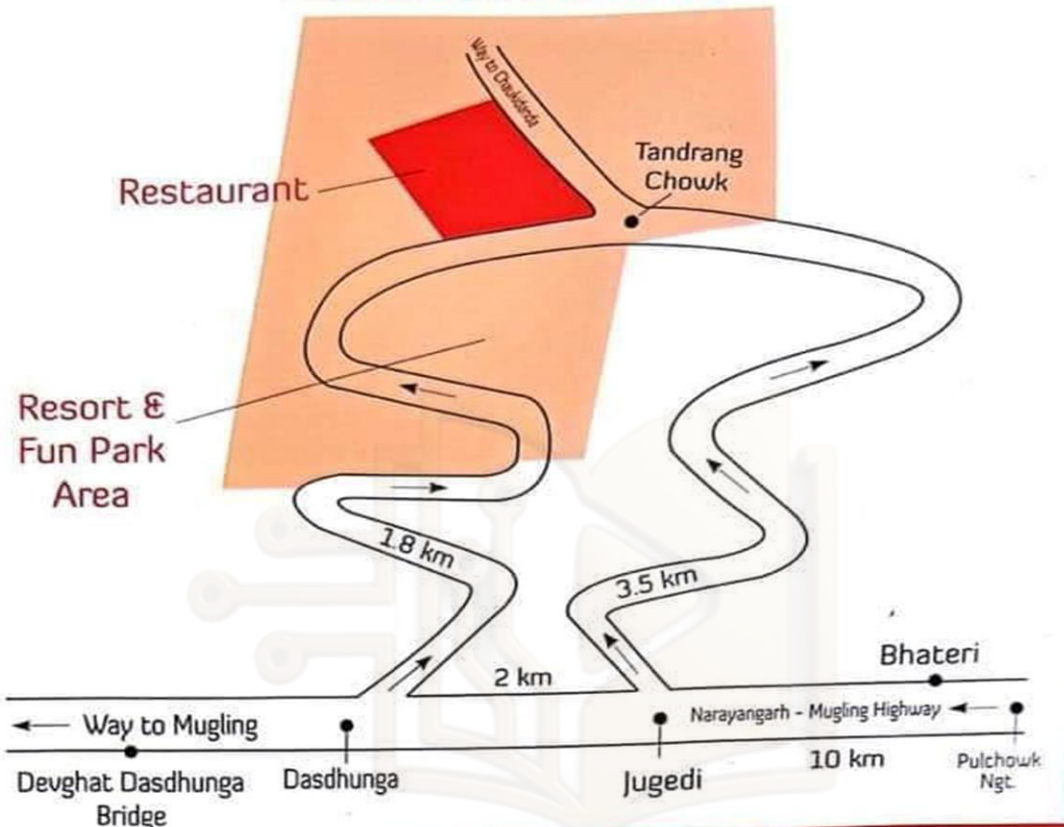
LOCATION MAP



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KABILAS RESORT AND FUN PARK PVT. LTD.

Above Narayangarh-Mugling Highway, 10 KM away from Bharatpur, Chitwan

Bharatpur-29, Tandrang, Kabilas, Chitwan

056-509000, 509001, 9855051900, 9855025901, 9855052907

rerservation.kabilas@gmail.com, kabilas.resort@gmail.com

kabilasresort

Bharatpur Contact Office: 056-515964

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Ads Samples

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NEW HOT PRODUCT! CHERRY LAPTOP – NEW MODEL!!! [C-312]

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

NEW!

This new model from CHERRY, C-312, will bring you even more convenience than ever! The following are its better-than-ever features:

-lightweight

-compact

-fast

-long-lasting battery

-equipped with antivirus security

*bonus feature…

-a complete set of microsoft programmes set-up just for you!

SO, HURRY UP AND BRING IT HOME! [available in all electronic retail shops.]

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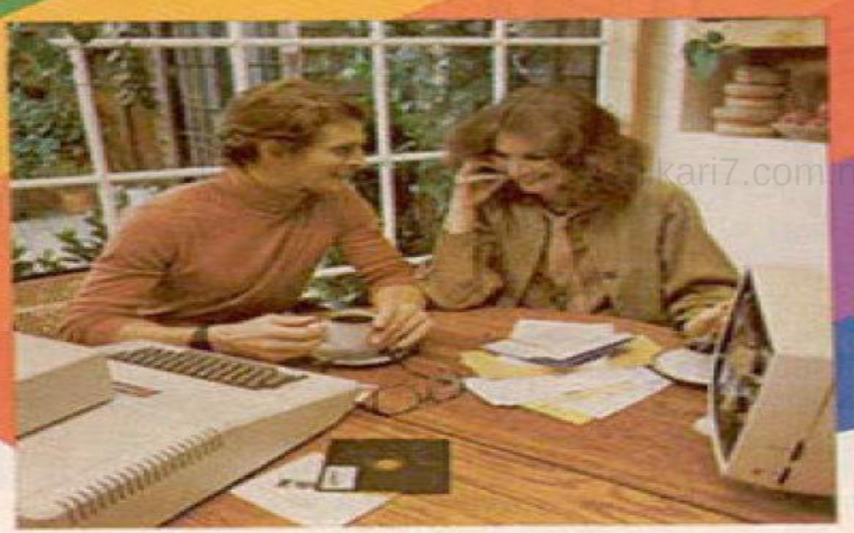

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Language part

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Writing technical prose

- **Clarity**
- **Cohesion**
- **Conciseness**
- **Plain language**
- **Parallelism**
- **Defining, describing, and explaining**

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Clarity

- **It is important to have clarity in your technical documents so that your target audience understands what you are asking of them and how to complete the task.**
- **Technical and scientific prose can be difficult to write clearly because of its often-specialized subject matter.**
- **At least, readers of technical and scientific prose can have difficulty understanding it—what the writer means is not at all clear—because they don't just "read" it, they interpret it.**
- **Readers assemble these ideas into a coherent pattern from which they construct the meaning of the sentence. They draw links between the main ideas that they have identified from sentence to sentence through a paragraph and from paragraph to paragraph through the text to build an understanding of what the document is "about."**
- **Understanding where readers look to find these clues can help you to situate the main ideas of your text in those places to help readers come closer to interpreting your meaning correctly.**

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Where do readers look for clues about the writer's main ideas? How can you help the readers find the main ideas?

- **Place the context or the familiar information on the left.**
- **Place main ideas as the subjects of sentences.**
- **Locate the subject and the verb close to one another.**
- **Place important ideas at the end of sentences to emphasize them.**
- **Place one point in each syntactic structure (i.e., unit containing a subject and verb).**
- **Place old information that links back in the subject position, and put new information that you want readers to attend to at the point of emphasis**
- **Use verbs rather than nominalizations to express action in your sentences**

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Examples

Term	Class	Features
LED	Semiconductor	■ Light bulb without a filament ■ Doesn't get hot
Saturated fat	Fats from animals	■ Solid at room temperature ■ Liquid when heated

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EXAMPLE 1.1

In the past, DIFFERENT RESEARCHERS have used a variety of techniques to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber. RESEARCHERS permitted the vapor, created through thermally vaporizing or evaporating a metal, to condense and be deposited on the substrate. CHEMICAL VAPOR DEPOSITION is another method wherein different gases introduced into the chamber react to form a compound on the substrate. Yet ANOTHER METHOD used by scientists is sputtering. A CATHODE, located inside a vacuum or gas-filled discharge tube, is disintegrated by bombardment until IT is vaporized and deposited on the substrate.

EXAMPLE 1.2

In the past, VARIOUS TECHNIQUES have been used to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber. ONE TECHNIQUE simply is to thermally vaporize or evaporate a metal, permitting the vapor to condense and be deposited on the substrate. ANOTHER METHOD is referred to as chemical vapor deposition wherein different gases are introduced into the vacuum chamber to react and form a compound on the substrate. Yet another EARLIER METHOD is referred to as sputtering. In this method, a vacuum or gas filled DISCHARGE TUBE has a cathode that is disintegrated by bombardment, so that THE CATHODE MATERIAL is vaporized and deposited on the substrate.

FIGURE 4.1
Placing main ideas as subjects.

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Possible question pattern for it.

Change as instructed in brackets.

a. **In the past, different researchers have used a variety of techniques to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber. *(Place the main idea as subject)***

Answer:

In the past, various techniques have been used to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber.

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EXAMPLE 2.1

1. A METHOD for the reactive plating of substrates to produce transparent conducting films and photoactive coatings IS DISCLOSED.

EXAMPLE 2.2

2. A METHOD IS DISCLOSED for the reactive plating of substrates to produce transparent conducting films and photoactive coatings.

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FIGURE 4.2
Placing subjects and verbs together.

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Possible question pattern for it.

a. A method for the reactive plating of substrates to produce transparent conducting films and photoactive coatings is disclosed. (place subjects and verb together)
b. Answer: A method is disclosed for the reactive plating of substrates to produce transparent conducting films and photoactive coatings.

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EXAMPLE 3.1

[1] Obesity is increasing at unprecedented rates WORLDWIDE (Seidell, 2000; Lu et al., 2001). [2] This increase suggests that more women than ever are entering pregnancy obese and that the incidence of pregnancy complications related to obesity IS INCREASING (Henrikson, 2006). [3] The combined degree of insulin resistance caused by pregnancy and obesity is greater than that for a NORMAL PREGNANCY, and, [4] as a result, the risk of gestational diabetes IS HIGHER. [5] It is more likely that, with a greater degree of insulin resistance, the beta cells (cells that produce insulin) will be unable to compensate, and hyperglycemia WILL DEVELOP (Kahn, Hull, & Utzschneider, 2006). [6] It remains unclear whether increased insulin resistance precedes beta-cell dysfunction in the development of gestational diabetes or beta-cell dysfunction precedes INSULIN RESISTANCE (Catalano, 2002). [7] Most studies of gestational diabetes stratify risk and plasma glucose concentration measurements by weight based on the differences in insulin resistance that occur AS OBESITY INCREASES (Catalano, 2002).

EXAMPLE 3.2

[1] Obesity is increasing worldwide at UNPRECEDENTED RATES (Seidell, 2000; Lu et al., 2001). [2] This increase suggests that more women than ever are entering pregnancy obese, simultaneously leading to an increase in obesity-related PREGNANCY COMPLICATIONS (Henrikson, 2006). [3] Normal pregnancy represents a small RISK OF INSULIN RESISTANCE; however, [4] combined pregnancy and obesity increases the risk of insulin resistance, increasing the risk of developing GESTATIONAL DIABETES. [5] It is more likely that, with a greater degree of insulin resistance, beta cells (cells that produce insulin) will be unable to compensate, causing the DEVELOPMENT OF HYPERGLYCEMIA (Kahn, Hull, & Utzschneider, 2006). It remains unclear in the development of gestational diabetes whether increased insulin resistance PRECEDES BETA-CELL DYSFUNCTION or [6] beta-cell dysfunction precedes INSULIN RESISTANCE (Catalano, 2002). [7] Most studies of gestational diabetes focus on the differences in insulin resistance that occur as obesity increases, so they stratify risk and plasma GLUCOSE CONCENTRATION MEASUREMENTS BY WEIGHT (Catalano, 2002).

FIGURE 4.3 Placing important ideas in the position of emphasis.

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EXAMPLE 6.1

[1] This trial WILL INVOLVE the process of construct validation, with the ultimate goal of contributing knowledge to the validity of the interpretations that ARE MADE on the basis of the exam mark. [2] An assessment of the true validity of the exam and the inferences drawn from it WOULD NEED TO HAVE a wider focus than looking at a single class offered (Weigle, 2002). [3] This type of assessment WOULD NEED TO LOOK more at the implications of the grades given in the course, which COULD BE DONE with an exam that HAS already BEEN SHOWN to measure what it WAS INTENDED to measure (Weigle, 2002). [4] This trial IS the first step towards a trial of the validity of inferences about how exam scores ARE USED, which MAY BE possible in the future.

EXAMPLE 6.2

[1] This trial EXAMINES the process of construct validation. [2] The process ultimately AIMS to contribute knowledge that WILL HELP instructors INTERPRET grades validly based on the exam mark. [3] To assess the true validity of the exam and to draw inferences from it, we SHOULD BROADEN the focus of the trial beyond looking at a single class (Weigle, 2002). [4] This type of assessment also MUST EXAMINE the implications of the grades given in the course, which a proven exam COULD DO, one that MEASURES what it was intended to measure (Weigle, 2002). [5] This trial CONSTITUTES the first step towards a trial of the validity of inferences about how exam scores ARE USED, which MAY BE POSSIBLE in the future.

FIGURE 4.6 Using verbs to express the main actions.

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Cohesion (intra—textual link)

- **Cohesion refers to the way we use vocabulary and grammatical structures to make connections between the ideas within a text.**
- **It provides flow and sequence to your work and helps make your paragraphs clear for the reader.**
- **Cohesive devices are words and expressions that show relationships between parts of text and ideas, such as cause and effect, time, addition, or comparison and contrast.**
- **Attention to cohesion helps readers interpret meaning; they experience the discourse as much clearer because ideas are clearly linked from one sentence to the next.**

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- **There are two methods of achieving cohesion:**

- **Linking sentences from start to start -**Use familiar information at the start of each sentence to link ideas from one to the next throughout a paragraph.
- **Linking sentences from end to start-** At the end of the sentence, in the position of emphasis, place new information. In the next sentence, the new information at the end of the previous sentence becomes the familiar information at the start, and new information is again added at the end of the sentence

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EXAMPLE 7

In the past, VARIOUS TECHNIQUES have been used to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber. ONE TECHNIQUE simply is to vaporize or evaporate a metal thermally, permitting the vapour to condense and be deposited on the substrate. ANOTHER METHOD is referred to as chemical vapor deposition wherein different gases are introduced into the vacuum chamber to react and form a compound on the substrate. Yet another, earlier METHOD is referred to as sputtering. In this METHOD, a vacuum or gas-filled discharge tube has a cathode that is disintegrated by bombardment, so the cathode material is vaporized and deposited on the substrate.

FIGURE 4.7 Linking sentences from start to start.

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EXAMPLE 8

[1] There are no universal guidelines for the level at which glucose intolerance should be labeled as gestational diabetes, making the DIAGNOSIS OF GESTATIONAL diabetes controversial (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [2] Currently, for a DIAGNOSIS OF GESTATIONAL diabetes, the generally accepted criteria is two abnormal glucose tolerance tests; women identified as having abnormal glucose levels through the screening test then undergo a DIAGNOSTIC TEST (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [3] However, SCREENING women for gestational diabetes has provoked some disagreement as to how, and if, it should be SCREENED for during pregnancy (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [4] SCREENING is supported by recent research indicating that higher levels of glucose intolerance lead to poorer pregnancy outcomes and that treatment significantly reduces these NEGATIVE OUTCOMES (Hapos et al., 2008). [5] The EFFECTS OF GESTATIONAL DIABETES are difficult to determine because of both the varied definitions used in the literature and the different implications of pregnancy, based on if and how gestational diabetes is treated (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009).

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FIGURE 4.8
Linking sentences from end to start.

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How can I create cohesion?

Linking words

and – to add information

however – to show contrast

therefore – to show cause and effect

although – to qualify

because – to show cause and effect

whilst – to signal concurrency

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Referring backwards

Pronouns: it, he, she, his, her, they, their

Demonstratives: this, that, these, those

Articles: a, the

Adverbs: previously, subsequently

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Looking forward

We often use words and phrases to highlight new information for the reader. This helps make a smooth transition from one point to another.

Such phrases include:

the following

as follows

below

next

subsequently

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Conciseness

- **Conciseness is communicating complete information about a topic or idea in a few words.**
- **Concise writing also involves being mindful of word choice.**
- **Concise writing removes or replaces filler, repetitive, and purposeless words from sentences.**
- **You can edit your writing for conciseness in a few ways.**

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Maintaining Conciseness in writing

1. Use active voice.

Example:

Passive voice: The groceries **were carried** into the apartment by Paula. (9 words)

Avoiding passive voice: Paula carried the groceries into the apartment. (7 words)

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2. Replace commonly used phrases

Example:

The department is on a tight budget this month **due to the fact that** it overspent the previous month. (19 words)

Avoiding commonly used phrases: The department is on a tight budget because of last month's overspending. (12 words)

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3. Remove redundant pairs

Example:

Each and every year, the marching band advances to the national competition. (12 words)

Avoiding redundant pairs: Every year, the marching band advances to the national competition. (10 words)

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4. Remove qualifiers

Example:

- It was somewhat cold that late-October evening which made the atmosphere extremely weird. (13 words)
- **Avoiding qualifiers:** It was cold and eerie that late-October evening. (8 words)

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solvent.

EXAMPLE 7

In the past, VARIOUS TECHNIQUES have been used to deposit a film or coating on a substrate located in a vacuum chamber. ONE TECHNIQUE simply is to vaporize or evaporate a metal thermally, permitting the vapour to condense and be deposited on the substrate. ANOTHER METHOD is referred to as chemical vapor deposition wherein different gases are introduced into the vacuum chamber to react and form a compound on the substrate. Yet another, earlier METHOD is referred to as sputtering. In this METHOD, a vacuum or gas-filled discharge tube has a cathode that is disintegrated by bombardment, so the cathode material is vaporized and deposited on the substrate.

FIGURE 4.7 Linking sentences from start to start.

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EXAMPLE 8

[1] There are no universal guidelines for the level at which glucose intolerance should be labeled as gestational diabetes, making the DIAGNOSIS OF GESTATIONAL diabetes controversial (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [2] Currently, for a DIAGNOSIS OF GESTATIONAL diabetes, the generally accepted criteria is two abnormal glucose tolerance tests; women identified as having abnormal glucose levels through the screening test then undergo a DIAGNOSTIC TEST (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [3] However, SCREENING women for gestational diabetes has provoked some disagreement as to how, and if, it should be SCREENED for during pregnancy (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009). [4] SCREENING is supported by recent research indicating that higher levels of glucose intolerance lead to poorer pregnancy outcomes and that treatment significantly reduces these NEGATIVE OUTCOMES (Hapos et al., 2008). [5] The EFFECTS OF GESTATIONAL DIABETES are difficult to determine because of both the varied definitions used in the literature and the different implications of pregnancy, based on if and how gestational diabetes is treated (Yogev, Metzger, & Hod, 2009).

FIGURE 4.8 Linking sentences from end to start.

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Plain language

- **Plain language is a movement among business, professional, technical, and government writers that seeks to communicate information to readers as clearly and comprehensibly as possible.**
- **This movement has led to a broad revision of health, legal, and government documents in countries such as the UK, Australia, Canada, and the United States to ensure that target readers can read and understand the documents that they must use.**
- **The plain language movement aims to produce documents that enable readers to “find what they need; understand what they find; and use what they find to meet their needs”.**

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Here are some of the main guidelines:

- **Find out who your audience is and write for those readers.**
- **If you have a mixed audience, address each group separately with the information that pertains to it.**
- **State the purpose of your document first and then the main point.**
- **Put the central point at the start and only include background information as necessary toward the end.**
- **Address the reader directly and use “you.”**
- **Use active verbs and the active voice.**
- **Use the passive voice only when it doesn’t matter who is doing the action.**

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Ten tips to make your writing easier to read

At the word level	1. Use words that are accurate, appropriate, and familiar. 2. Use technical jargon sparingly; eliminate business jargon altogether. 3. Use active verbs most of the time. 4. Use strong verbs (not nouns) to carry the weight of your sentence.
At the sentence level	5. Tighten your writing (eliminate unnecessary words). 6. Vary sentence length and sentence structure. 7. Use parallel structure. (See section below on parallelism.) 8. Put your readers in your sentences. 9. Begin most paragraphs with topic sentences. 10. Use transitions to link ideas.

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Parallelism

- **Parallel structure (also called parallelism) is the repetition of a chosen grammatical form within a sentence.**
- **By making each compared item or idea in your sentence follow the same grammatical pattern, you create a parallel construction.**
- **Parallelism, the use of matching grammatical structure, is especially challenging in technical and workplace communication when you write lists.**

Example:

Not Parallel: **Ellen likes hiking, the rodeo, and to take afternoon naps.**

Parallel: **Ellen likes hiking, attending the rodeo, and taking afternoon naps.**

OR

Ellen likes to hike, attend the rodeo, and take afternoon naps.

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Not Parallel: My best friend took me dancing and to a show.

Parallel: My best friend took me to a dance and a show.

Not Parallel: My dog not only likes to play fetch, but also chase cars.
Parallel: My dog not only likes to play fetch, but he also likes to chase cars.

Not Parallel: I would rather pay for my education than financial aid.
Parallel: I would rather pay for my education than receive financial aid.

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Not Parallel: John Taylor Gatto criticizes public schools because they are compulsory, funded by the government, and destroy students' humanity.

Parallel: John Taylor Gatto criticizes public schools because they are compulsory, government-funded, and normalizing.

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Defining, describing, and explaining

- As a technical communicator, you will frequently adjust your writing to meet the expectations of readers who have varying levels of knowledge of the subject matter.
- Definition and description are useful tools.
- Definitions are used to explain subject matter related to concepts or terms.
- If readers are unfamiliar with a term, a well-placed definition can educate them exactly when they need it.
- Sometimes a term may have different meanings in different contexts, so you define it to clarify how you are using it in your document.
- A clear definition removes potential confusion and ambiguity.
- A description is a verbal portrait of something—an object or an event.

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Definition

Definitions come in three kinds:

- **Brief**
- **Formal or categorical**
- **Extended**

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Brief definition

- **A brief definition is the practice of clarifying the meaning of a word by substituting a more familiar synonym (i.e., a parenthetical definition) or restating a word in different terms to make its meaning clear.**
- **Use a brief definition when your readers do not need detailed information.**

Example:

- **The Archimedean screw is a wooden pump that was developed two millennia ago. The screw is encased in a cylinder, and water is lifted up by the screw when the handle is turned. When the water reaches the top of the screw, it pours out, into a pitcher or basin placed to catch it.**

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Formal or categorical definition

A formal or categorical definition dates back to Aristotle's time in ancient Greece (500 BCE) and consists of three parts:

- **The term**
- **The class**
- **The features**

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Example:

Here are several examples of categorical definitions (i.e., they "categorize" the term):

- An LED (light-emitting diode) [*the term*] is the simplest type of semiconductor [*the class*] that is a small light bulb without a filament and that doesn't get hot [*the features*].
- Saturated fats [*the term*] are fats produced from animals [*the class*] that are solid at room temperature and liquid when heated [*the features*].
- Wind turbines [*the term*] are power generators [*the class*] that create electricity from the power of the wind [*the features*].

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Extended definition

A third type of definition that you may use is the extended definition, which refers to a more detailed characterization than the previous two.

Use them when readers need more detail.

The length should be based on both your readers' needs and your purpose in writing it: it may be as short as a paragraph or as long as several pages.

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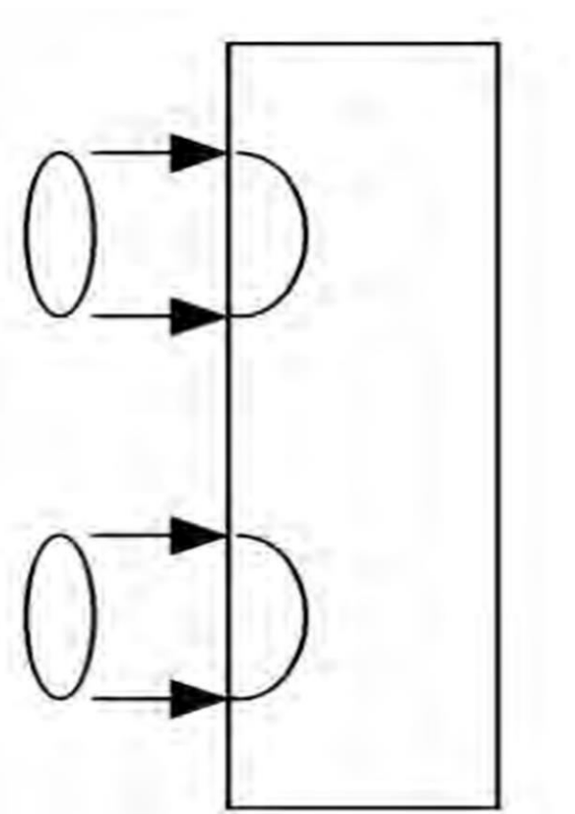
Example

A. HOW A BISCUIT JOINER WORKS

A biscuit joiner is a small hand-held tool that cuts thin, half-moon-shaped slices of wood from the vertical sides of planed boards so that they can form a strong joint when they are glued together. Think of your tabletop, which is usually fashioned from a series of planks joined side by side. Small, oval wafers of wood coated with glue are then inserted into the half-moon-shaped incisions in the planks and clamped together until the glue dries. A series of skillfully cut biscuit joints will result in a perfectly flat, almost seamless looking tabletop that is both sturdy and beautiful.



B. HOW TO MAKE A BISCUIT JOINT

To make a biscuit joint, you will need the following:

- Two planks of equal thickness
- Waterproof wood glue
- Three or four 5 cm biscuit wafers
- Two or three pipe clamps
- Biscuit joiner

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1. Calculate how many joints you will need (space them 8 to 12 inches apart).
2. Mark their locations on the right side of one plank and the left side of the other (i.e., the two surfaces that you will be joining together).
3. Hold the joiner parallel to the edge where you plan to make the joints.
4. Following your placement marks, depress trigger and form first joint.

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- **Here is a list of strategies for developing extended definitions and descriptions:**

- **Operational definition**
- **Negative definition**
- **Description of parts**
- **History/background**
- **Etymology**
- **Examples**
- **Cause and effect**
- **Analogy/comparison**

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Thank you

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